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United States Patent	12396554
Kind Code	B1
Date of Patent	August 26, 2025
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Equipment disinfection cabinet

Abstract

A disinfection or sterilization cabinet includes a cabinet frame defining an interior space, a door coupled to the cabinet frame, and an internal cabinet framework coupled to the cabinet frame and disposed within the interior space. The door is movable between a first position that substantially prevents access to the interior space and a second position that enables access to the interior space. The internal cabinet framework includes at least one bracket coupling structure. At least one bracket is removably coupled to the internal cabinet framework via the at least one bracket coupling structure. The at least one bracket includes a low contact object configured to reduce a contact area of an object supported by the at least one bracket and the at least one bracket. The cabinet includes a disinfectant or sterilization element configured to at least partially disinfect or sterilize the object.

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Appl. No.:	17/693238
Filed:	March 11, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation-in-part parent-doc US 17374890 20210713 PENDING child-doc US 17693238
us-provisional-application US 63051372 20200713

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: A47B49/00 (20060101); A47B57/22 (20060101); A61L2/10 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **A47B49/004** (20130101); **A47B57/22** (20130101); **A61L2/10** (20130101);
A61L2202/122 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: A61L (2202/122); A61L (2/10); A61L (2202/11); A47L (15/0076); A47L (15/4236); A47L (15/4251); A47L (15/50); A47B (57/50); A47B (57/22); A47B (49/004); A47B (63/062); A46B (17/065)

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation-in-part of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/374,890, filed Jul. 13, 2021, which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/051,372, filed on Jul. 13, 2020, each of which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

(1) Decontamination involves processes or treatments that render devices, instruments, or items and their surfaces safe to handle. Sterilization, disinfection, and antisepsis are all forms of decontamination. Disinfection refers to the elimination of virtually all pathogenic organisms on inanimate objects and surfaces thereby reducing the level of microbial contamination to an acceptably safe level.

(2) The need to disinfect is arguably a more urgent part of our lifestyles today as awareness of our unseen microbial risk has become exponentially greater. Our society may carefully integrate ways to significantly reduce the risk of contaminate transmission between people, animals and objects and surfaces. Governments, institutions, schools, businesses, hospitals, clinics, remote hospitals, ships at sea, casinos, and many other unique environments need to acquire the capability to disinfect the items in use and the current art is extremely limited in the technology, practicality, flexibility and efficiency it offers. In similar historical innovations, institutions installed commercial dishwashers on site as the proven means to disinfect and sanitize eating utensils and dentists and orthodontist offices installed autoclaves on site to disinfect and sterilize dental devices/tools. Those new methods were created and adopted to address the health risks that were known at the time and became the operating standard. With the COVID-19 virus and many other possible contaminants throughout the world, the current art does not have an easily adoptable solution that can help any institution reduce the risk of transmission of potentially fatal viruses or bacteria and other contagions by an improved method for disinfection of items in use.

(3) There is a substantial market and urgent demand for machines and methods of disinfection of many different objects and surfaces that may have come in contact with bacteria, viruses, or other contagions/diseases, collectively referred to as contaminants for this purpose. The market demand centers around the desire to prevent new exposures or additional exposures of these contaminants to people or animals or environments or objects. These contaminants have the common characteristic of being able to harm the health of those exposed. Exposure to contaminants can be fatal.

(4) Humans and animals, when exposed to a contaminant can carry the contaminant and become a transmitter with (symptomatic) and without (a-symptomatic) personal symptoms. Transmission can occur between people or objects or surfaces without the transmitter experiencing the contaminant. Exposure to contaminants can come from unaware transmitters. When a human or animal reports symptoms of exposure to a contaminant, they often seek medical care. They are aware of an abnormality in their health yet are undiagnosed by a formal process and thus, they are a transmitter just before and during their being infected/affected by the contaminant.

(5) For any institutional environment wanting to achieve a lower risk of contamination, definitive measures are required. The health care setting provides the most acute example. Medical patients (human or animals) and the workers who serve them are the most at-risk for contamination due to the worker's frequency and amount of exposures and the existing patient health vulnerabilities. Medical patients enable risk of contamination by submitting to a foreign environment of unknown sterility. Medical workers enable risk to their health by reporting for work duties while also

becoming the transmission mechanism patient-to-patient, room-to-room, floor-to-floor, worker-to-worker. Contaminants are invisible and highly transmittable via touch, sneeze, cough, breathing, talking, or any close contact with the contaminant that is then passed along to the next person, object, surface or environment. In any institutional setting (e.g. hospitals, clinics, schools, offices, etc.) organizations spend many billions each year to prevent health consequences of contamination as well as attempt to cure instances of contamination. Objects most commonly contaminated fall into the categories of equipment, devices, and supplies.

(6) Preventive approaches include worker use of disposable products and materials that may come in contact with contaminants and are therefore discarded after one or few uses (e.g.: gloves, masks, face shields, face helmets, testing materials, gowns, slippers, safety glasses/goggles, and more). The current art of disposable products fails when the supply chain fails to supply the demand, leading to shortages and the need to reuse disposable products and add additional risk to workers and customers/patients. The current art does not address the need to reuse disposable items when there are supply shortages. The current art does not make it practical to disinfect and reuse disposable items when it makes sense to do so. For example, a health worker going from room to room in a hospital could reuse certain disposable items if they were disinfected between rooms, or every few hours, or at the end of a work shift, etc.

(7) Preventive approaches include the manual wiping or spraying of surfaces and products and materials that are not disposable include periodic cleaning with user-applied disinfection method (e.g. chemical solutions). Further, preventive approaches include the training of workers on best practices to avoid spreading contaminants as well as applied cleaning methods. The contaminants that remain upon any object or surface following any disinfection effort are directly determined by the thoroughness of the human effort and machine or chemical capability. As contaminants are invisible, the probability of 100% disinfection is very low with the current art as practiced by institutions and the people or animals they serve. As an example in a medical environment, items such as testing equipment, digital thermometers, stethoscopes, blood pressure cuffs, monitoring pads/sensors, clip boards, pens, pencils, digital tablets, worker phones, safety glasses/goggles, worker shoes, durable gloves, and many more items, will come in contact with workers and patients whereby these items are potential transmitters of contaminants and current preventive manual measures are either unavailable or inadequate. In fact, when health care workers are surveyed, they report being scared to go home with their shoes, phone, and other personal effects potentially contaminated. As an example in a school or institution, items such as backpacks, phones, tablets, laptops, lunch boxes, basketballs, footballs, markers, erasers, tape dispensers, staplers, and many more common items will come in contact with workers, guests and students whereby these items are potential transmitters of contaminants and current preventive manual measures are either unavailable or inadequate.

(8) Aside from preventive efforts, governments and institutions spend billions each year on antibiotics and anti-viral drugs administered to human and animal patients after they have been infected due to transmission. If the current art was more effective in preventing transmission, these reactionary expenses could be significantly reduced.

(9) Practicality becomes an important factor in any effort to prevent transmission of contaminants. Since we cannot easily identify transmitters or contaminants, efforts are scrutinized for cost vs. benefit and feasibility. For example, it isn't feasible to disinfect every person, animal, the objects they carry and the clothes they wear upon entry in any doorway. If that were possible, an environment could be made 100% contaminant-free. Per above, people or animals cannot be disinfected in a practical sense. The current art can attempt to isolate if symptomatic but the environment, other people, workers, objects, devices, tools, etc. remain potential transmitters. It is not practical to manually disinfect every inch of surface of every floor, wall, object, device, machine, test material, button, etc. every time it is touched. Because of impracticality of the above, every worker, their equipment, surfaces, objects, devices and anything that could have made

contact with a transmitter or contaminant is suspect-which is the primary reason for fear that drives the market demand.

(10) There are many methods that can be used to disinfect objects and surfaces, but the current art has severe limitations. Contaminants can include viruses, bacteria and all contagions. There are many ways to “kill” each of these when encountered on a surface or embedded in material. One proven disinfection method includes the use of ultra-violet light in the “C” classification, UV-C, which operates at light wavelengths 200-280 nm (See FIG. 10G). There are handheld UV-C emitting devices on the market. One hand-held product requires a user can use a wand to flash-disinfect a surface. Uneven and inadequate and incomplete exposure to UV-C rays is probable with this type of device. UV-C is a known carcinogen for skin and can damage corneas among other sensitive tissues. For any hand-held solution, the operator is responsible to assure 100% exposure to the needed surface for disinfection and requires the operator to assure the needed exposure time for every amount of surface area, calculated in the art as:

$UV \text{ dose } \mu Ws/cm.^2 = UV \text{ intensity } \mu W/cm.^2 \times \text{exposure time (seconds)}$

(11) Thus, the proper disinfection “dose” of UV-C light is dependent upon the UV-C light intensity, distance, and exposure time, whereby distance and time are subjective to the user and highly likely to be rushed or skipped as there is no way to see or measure disinfection progress/success (e.g. imagine mowing a lawn and not seeing the cut grass). Also, any blockage of light-of-sight exposure leaves areas unexposed and therefore untreated by this disinfection method.

(12) There are disinfection boxes available on the market whereby consumer users can place their phone, keys, wallet or other small objects inside the container and a dose of UV-C light is introduced. While this box keeps harmful light from reaching outside, objects are placed atop surfaces that fully or partially occlude the light from reaching the objects. The box cannot achieve equal light-of-sight exposure or even assure any light-of-sight exposure based upon the placement of the objects in the container. Adequate exposure is suspect. Timing for what is adequate for the objects and their position within the box to achieve the proper dose is also suspect. Also, these boxes are designed for small objects and their overall design is one for consumer use of personal, small items with extended exposure times required. In general, for containment boxes offering to disinfect objects, there is a high risk of recontamination if the same door and edge outside surfaces are touched after a disinfection effort has been completed on the inside (i.e., “going out thru the in door”). Someone's hand opened the door when contents are suspect and that same hand will open the door to unload disinfected items. The single door approach requires incredible discipline to overcome the recontamination risk.

(13) Another method in the current art involves a large container with a series of holding clips (e.g. the clothesline) strung across many strings or wires and UV-C light bulbs alongside the container walls whereby user(s) can enter the container to attach various items to be disinfected (devices, supplies, masks, shields, gloves, gowns, coats) and then close the container and turn on the UV-C light for 30-180 minutes or more. The limitations to this method are many: The container is too large and heavy to be brought into a normal interior working environment. Contaminated materials/objects may be transported through clean environments to reach the container, exposing additional rooms, floors, HVAC systems, and people to contamination. Items are hung in a way to create uncertain light-of-sight exposure, clips can cover contaminated areas of each item, and the same doors are used to get access to disinfected items as were used to load contaminated items. Additionally, a small “load” is impractical or requires more volume to justify a disinfection cycle due to the size of container or duration of the treatment.

(14) Generally, all forms of the current art for using UV-C light as a disinfection method have the items to be disinfected and the UV-C light bulbs in fixed positions, assuring blind spots for line-of-sight exposure, uneven light dosage, and higher required duration to overcome the above weaknesses, with added sensibility dependency on operators who may not understand how a proper dose of UV-C is administered based upon intensity and distance and time. Additionally, the current

art fails to position the items to be disinfected by UV-C light in a manner that exposes all surfaces, leaving pockets of unreachable potential contamination. Also, the current art of using UV-C light as a disinfection method is ineffective upon contaminant bodies that are clumped or intertwined within layers or fibers just underneath the surface.

(15) Another available method of disinfection is to expose the contaminants to high heat, varying levels of humidity, and air flow. High temperatures above 140 degrees Fahrenheit degrade and kill bacteria, viruses and other known pathogens. The current art does not have a practical way of heating surfaces and spaces to achieve disinfection from a portability and containment standpoint. From research, scientists have proven that higher temperatures can destroy living contaminants. Additive to heat is the variable, humidity. Again from research, it is known that high humidity and low humidity have enhanced disinfection effectiveness of living contaminants when combined with high heat. Also from research, it is known that positive air flow (vs. a vacuum) has enhanced disinfection effectiveness upon living contaminants.

(16) Yet another current method of disinfecting items like facemasks or other higher risk items is to contain the items inside large containers and expose them for several hours to vaporized hydrogen peroxide or chlorine-based sanitizing solutions. Liquid compounds when vaporized can reach all exposed surfaces. This approach fails in several ways, including the following. The condensed liquid creates dripping residue from one item to another (following gravity) so that one person's mask residue (for example) drips onto another's. Contaminated items may be transported from a clean space, through clean spaces, to be loaded into a contaminated space. The same doors are used to load contaminated items and their exterior is not disinfected to any known certainty when items are unloaded. The process takes hours to complete and can leave the items moist. User error can result in items stacked too closely to prevent adequate exposure to this disinfection method.

(17) Considering the above described current art of UV-C light exposure, heat and air exposure, and vaporized liquid exposure, each of these approaches fail for certain materials within the items to be disinfected. Not all materials can receive UV-C light, not all materials can withstand high heat, and not all materials can be exposed to hydrogen peroxide, chlorine or many other chemicals that may be used in solution.

(18) The current industry is constantly looking for cheaper, practical, flexible, effective, and portable disinfection products and methods as well as methods and systems for implementation, operating, maintaining, and distribution to the consuming public. Thus, there is a need for a new and improved disinfection product, system, and method of disinfection and general use as disclosed herein.

SUMMARY

(19) One exemplary embodiment relates to a disinfection or sterilization cabinet includes a cabinet frame defining an interior cabinet space, at least one door coupled to the cabinet frame, and an internal cabinet framework coupled to the cabinet frame and disposed within the interior cabinet space. At least one door is movable between a first position that substantially prevents access to the interior cabinet space and a second position spaced apart from the cabinet frame that enables access to the interior cabinet space. The internal cabinet framework includes at least one bracket coupling structure. At least one bracket is removably coupled to the internal cabinet framework via the at least one bracket coupling structure. At least one bracket includes a low contact surface object configured to reduce the contact area of an object supported by at least one bracket. The cabinet includes at least one disinfectant or sterilization element configured to at least partially disinfect or sterilize the object supported by at least one bracket.

(20) Another exemplary embodiment relates to an interior framework for a disinfectant or sterilization cabinet. The interior framework includes a central structure comprising a central shaft, the central structure configured to rotate about a central axis within the disinfectant or sterilization cabinet and an outer structure coupled with the central structure and configured to rotate with the central structure. The central shaft is removably coupled with the central structure. The outer

structure includes a plurality of bracket attachment points configured to couple with one or more brackets. The one or more brackets are configured to support an object such that the object rotates with the central structure.

(21) Another exemplary embodiment relates to a bracket for supporting an object within a disinfection or sterilization cabinet. The bracket includes a bracket base defining a first opening and a second opening. The first opening is configured to receive a protrusion of an interior framework of the disinfection or sterilization cabinet. The second opening is configured to detachably receive a bracket attachment. The bracket attachment includes one or more low-contact features configured to fit a specific type of object while also reducing the contact area of the object supported by at least one bracket coupled with the interior framework within the disinfection or sterilization cabinet.

(22) The present disclosure relates to medical and personal protective equipment disinfection systems and methods. More particularly, the disclosure relates to a new and improved item disinfection cabinet and method, method for making, distributing, using, and system thereof. Rendering various living contaminants such as viruses and bacteria inert to prevent transmission to other objects and people involves applying a disinfection method to an item. Prior art cases involve a single disinfection method unevenly applied to each item in costly, time-consuming and impractical manners with unknown effectiveness. The disclosed cabinet provides an affordable, convenient, and flexible disinfection method and result. The cabinet includes a portable industrial-grade sealed enclosure for the loading of items needing disinfection with one or more access doors whereby multiple and different disinfection methods are available sequentially or concurrently in a disinfection treatment plan that is selected for its effectiveness per the items and their materials and the targeted contaminants. All disinfection methods are more effective due to the movement between item and disinfection source. Items are presented for treatment via time-saving, quick-change mounting brackets designed purposely to secure and present each item type uniquely. The cabinet enables a room partition separation discipline for “dirty” vs. “clean” item loading and unloading through separate access doors. The cabinet uses computer controlled hardware and software to operate, monitor and set testing and treatment cycles. As such, the general purpose is to provide a new and improved disinfection device and method which has all the advantages of the prior art and none of the disadvantages.

(23) A disinfection treatment plan prescription can be based upon [contaminant×materials×disinfection method×duration].

(24) The current art lacks a comprehensive yet fitting approach to matching the disinfection treatment plan to the items requiring disinfection.

(25) The current art fails to be portable in its use. Requirements of the art include that industrial/institutional disinfection containers may be outside, lifted by forklifts, contaminated products may be transported through clean areas to reach the disinfection location, etc. The disinfection capability of the current art is incapable of being located nearest the sources of contamination to avoid spread of contaminants as well as being operationally practical.

(26) The current art fails to be easily accessible for loading and unloading by the operator whereby operators may physically enter a container to arrange items or may work around hardware, racks, shelves, doors, wires and more to place or remove items. This limitation places significant bending, reaching, and other movements that can create injury over time or are movements not possible for aged or small or large persons.

(27) The current art fails to leave the environment inert following vapor treatments whereby users are cautioned when the enclosure is opened that residue can remain that is hazardous to operators or item users. Additionally, the current art involves external evacuation of air/vapor or open door “airing out” of the enclosure to render the items and enclosure air inert to humans or animals. These provisions are further inflexibility, danger, and cost to the institution.

(28) The current art fails to be time-efficient in its use. Waiting an hour or hours for a process to

complete requires significant extra inventory of the items to be disinfected. Waiting until a container is full to run a “cycle” creates unnecessary wait time or requires excess inventory. Transporting disinfected items from a disinfection site to the area of use is time-consuming and laborious.

(29) The current art fails to be affordable in its use. During the COVID-19 epidemic alone, governments and institutions have spent hundreds of millions of dollars on 3rd party sterilization services using the above approaches to disinfection, with expenses as high as \$7 per mask disinfection. Affordability is possible when the government or institution can self-administer item disinfection on-demand in a controlled manner.

(30) The current art lacks availability for a disinfection solution for common objects that come in contact with contaminants. A school, business, or institution desiring to have a disinfection capability cannot find affordable assets to purchase so that they have such capability in convenient locations when they need it at an operating complexity they can execute with confidence.

(31) The current art lacks a comprehensive approach to matching the disinfection treatment plan to the items requiring disinfection.

(32) The current art lacks the ability to combine two or more disinfection methods in a manner that customizes a disinfection treatment plan (based upon items to be treated or contaminants targeted).

(33) The current art lacks the ability to provide a multi-method attack upon contaminants within the same treatment cycle whereby thoroughness is enhanced by employing multiple disinfection methods simultaneously or in a series within the same cycle.

(34) The current art lacks robustness and discipline whereby the user does not have pre-configured treatment plan options or software controls that are of known efficacy for the varied items and materials and circumstances encountered by the government or institution. Rather, the current art requires the user to manage key aspects of technologies and treatments as a pseudo-expert to assure treatment efficacy without the assistance of technology controls that operate and communicate system and cycle status.

(35) The current art lacks the ability to be a closed system whereby the air and vapor generated for disinfection purposes and fluids can be rendered inert and of nominal impact to operator or item users immediately following treatment. Rather, existing systems require exhausted air, heat, vapor to outdoors which is at either great expense to modify buildings or at great inconvenience as disinfection may be performed outside the normal workspace for the institution.

(36) A disinfection cabinet includes: a transportable cabinet frame having a horizontally disposed base, at least one vertically disposed bounding wall, a horizontally disposed top; at least one rotating framework for holding and presenting items for disinfection within the cabinet, the rotating framework configured to rotate about a vertical axis and having plural attachment points; at least two different types of item holders configured for attachment to the attachment points, each of the two different types of item holders configured for holding a different type of item to be disinfected; and at least one disinfecting light source positioned within the cabinet.

(37) The cabinet can further include: at least one heat source configured to heat the interior of the cabinet; and at least one vapor delivery source configured to deliver a disinfecting vapor within the cabinet. The vapor delivery source can be configured to regulate humidity and chemical saturation level within the cabinet.

(38) The cabinet can further include: at least two access doors mounted to the cabinet frame and providing access to an interior of the cabinet through two separate access door openings, wherein each of the access door openings is positioned on an opposite side of the cabinet frame. The cabinet can further include: at least one means for circulating air in the interior of the cabinet. An air source can be configured to provide a supply of air to or remove air from the interior of the cabinet.

(39) The cabinet can further include: a control system configured to control and regulate application of multiple disinfection methods in accordance with a customizable treatment plan. The customizable treatment plan can be based upon the type or composition of items to be disinfected.

(40) The cabinet can further include: for at least one of the at least one framework, at least one guide feature extending vertically for at least a majority of a height of the framework, the guide feature extending along a parallel to an axis of rotation of the framework so as to nudge items on the rotating carousel into intended positions within a predefined circumference around the axis of rotation as the framework rotates. The framework can include one or more vertically disposed outer members having the one or more attachment points, and wherein at least one item holder attached to one of vertically disposed outer members is positioned with a centerline that is angled between an intersection of a first plane tangent to a circumference of rotation of the vertically disposed outer member and a second plane extending along the axis of rotation of the framework as well as the vertically disposed outer member.

(41) The cabinet can further include: a drive mechanism configured to rotate the rotating framework, wherein the drive mechanism is configured to permit slippage of rotation of the framework in case of blockage or manual movement of the framework during loading or unloading.

(42) A method for disinfecting items includes: opening a first access door providing internal access to a transportable disinfection cabinet through a first opening in the cabinet; loading through the first opening a batch of different items onto at least two different types of item holders, each of the two different types of item holders configured for holding a different type of item to be disinfected, each of the items holders being attached to an attachment point on a rotating framework within the cabinet; closing the first access door after loading the batch of items; causing the cabinet to perform a disinfection process on contents of the cabinet, wherein the disinfection process includes: rotating the framework on a vertical axis of rotation within an interior of the cabinet, and exposing the items to a disinfecting light source positioned within the cabinet; in response to an indication from the cabinet that the disinfection process is complete, opening a second access door providing internal access to the cabinet through a second opening in the cabinet positioned on an opposite side of the cabinet from the first opening; and removing the batch of items from the framework through the second opening.

(43) The disinfection process can further include: exposing the items to air movement and circulation within the cabinet, operating a heat source configured to heat the interior of the cabinet, and operating a vapor delivery source configured to deliver a disinfecting vapor to the interior of the cabinet. The disinfecting vapor can include water vapor, wherein the water vapor raises a humidity level in the cabinet.

(44) The disinfection process can be driven by a control system configured to control and regulate application of multiple disinfection mechanisms in accordance with a customizable treatment plan. The control system can be configured to receive data from one or more sensors within the cabinet to sense: motion of items within the cabinet, and operation of one or more disinfection methods, wherein the control system is configured to control the treatment plan in response to data received from the one or more sensors. The customizable treatment plan can be based upon the type or composition of items to be disinfected.

(45) The method can further include: at least one guide feature of the cabinet nudging items on the rotating carousel into intended positions within a predefined circumference around the axis of rotation as the framework rotates.

(46) The framework can include one or more vertically disposed outer members having the attachment points, and wherein at least one item holder attached to one of vertically disposed outer members is positioned with a centerline that is angled between an intersection of a first plane tangent to a circumference of rotation of the vertically disposed outer member and a second plane extending along the axis of rotation of the framework as well as the vertically disposed outer member. The items can include personal protective equipment.

(47) The invention is capable of other embodiments and of being carried out in various ways. Numerous specific details are provided to impart a thorough understanding of embodiments of the

subject matter of the present disclosure. The described features of the subject matter of the present disclosure may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments and/or implementations. In this regard, one or more features of an aspect of the invention may be combined with one or more features of a different aspect of the invention. Moreover, additional features may be recognized in certain embodiments and/or implementations that may not be present in all embodiments or implementations.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

- (1) The disclosure will become more fully understood from the following detailed description, taken in conjunction with the accompanying figures, wherein like reference numerals refer to like elements, in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates a high perspective view of the external surfaces and working components and important features of the cabinet.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates a high perspective view of the internal space and working components and item movement and light circulation of the cabinet, including the item movement multi-exposure embodiment.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates a high perspective view of the internal space and the light, air, heat and vapor circulation throughout the cabinet as part of the simultaneous and serial multi-disinfection method embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates a high perspective view of the internal space and the cabinet's item physical guide embodiment and interior space saving embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates a high perspective view of the cabinet's multi-layered frame whereby all facets of the cabinet have at least two layers and a space between those layers, allowing for all wiring and connectivity to be embedded between those layers and also providing insulation and heat dissipation between the interior and exterior of the cabinet.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a high perspective view of the cabinet as part of the room partition embodiment whereby the cabinet's multiple doors and cabinet combined with a drape or curtain or wall allows for separate work spaces, one for contaminated and one for disinfected.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates a high perspective view of the item presentation framework embodiment of the cabinet whereby item mounting attachment points are located on the framework and item mounting brackets can be attached at one or more item mounting attachment points.
- (9) FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrate a high perspective view of the many possible item mounting brackets variably arranged and attached to the framework as item presentation framework embodiment of the cabinet.
- (10) FIG. 9 illustrates a high perspective view of the internal space and item presentation to disinfection methods using the mounting bracket offset embodiment of the cabinet.
- (11) FIGS. 10A-D illustrate exposure to all disinfection methods and treatments by changing the position between item and disinfection method.
- (12) FIG. 10E illustrates pre-set or variable treatment plans that are a combination of disinfection methods, either in serial or overlapping order, with adjusted thresholds and duration
- (13) FIG. 10F illustrates use of sensors to assure the needed environmental factors are reached and maintained to assure treatment efficacy and operator safety.
- (14) FIG. 10G illustrates the range of UV light in the electromagnetic spectrum.
- (15) FIG. 11 illustrates a multi-wing carrousel embodiment whereby the carrousel is driven from the drive clutch.
- (16) FIG. 12 illustrates a cross sectional elevation view of a four-corner embodiment where the rotating carrousel is surrounded by germicidal light sources.

(17) FIG. 13 illustrates a cross sectional overhead view of a four-corner embodiment where the rotating carrousel is surrounded by germicidal light sources.

(18) FIG. 14 illustrates a side view of a multiple access door embodiment whereby doors are located on opposite sides of the cabinet.

(19) FIG. 15 shows an embodiment including a door with pull handle.

(20) FIG. 16 illustrates a perspective cut away view of a four-corner embodiment where the cabinet's structural frame is also an air duct.

(21) FIG. 17 illustrates an embodiment of the cabinet's internal space using item physical guides.

(22) FIG. 18 is a perspective view of a disinfection and/or sterilization cabinet, according to an example embodiment.

(23) FIG. 19 is a perspective view of a disinfection and/or sterilization cabinet, according to another example embodiment.

(24) FIG. 20 is a front view of a universal bracket base, according to an example embodiment.

(25) FIG. 21 is a cross-sectional view of the universal bracket base of FIG. 20, according to an example embodiment.

(26) FIG. 22 is a detail view of the coupling structure of the universal bracket base of FIG. 21, according to an example embodiment.

(27) FIG. 23 is a side view of a universal bracket base, according to an example embodiment.

(28) FIG. 24 is a top view of an interior framework of a cabinet, according to an example embodiment.

(29) FIGS. 25A and 25B are a front (FIG. 25A) and rear (FIG. 25B) perspective views of a bracket, according to an example embodiment.

(30) FIGS. 26A and 26B are front (FIG. 26A) and rear (FIG. 26B) perspective views of a bracket, according to another example embodiment.

(31) FIGS. 27A and 27B are front (FIG. 27A) and rear (FIG. 27B) perspective views of a bracket, according to still another example embodiment.

(32) FIGS. 28A and 28B are front (FIG. 28A) and rear (FIG. 28B) perspective views of a bracket, according to yet another example embodiment.

(33) FIGS. 29A and 29B are front (FIG. 29A) and rear (FIG. 29B) perspective views of a bracket, according to yet another example embodiment.

(34) FIGS. 30A and 30B are front (FIG. 30A) and rear (FIG. 30B) perspective views of a bracket, according to yet another example embodiment.

(35) FIG. 31 is a front perspective view of a bracket, according to still another example embodiment.

(36) FIGS. 32A and 32B are front (FIG. 32A) and rear (FIG. 32B) perspective views of a bracket, according to a further example embodiment.

(37) FIGS. 33A and 33B are a front (FIG. 33A) and rear (FIG. 33B) elevation view of a bracket, according to another example embodiment.

(38) FIGS. 34A and 34B are front (FIG. 34A) and rear (FIG. 34B) perspective views of a bracket, according to still another example embodiment.

(39) FIGS. 35A and 35B are front (FIG. 35A) and rear (FIG. 35B) elevation views of a bracket, according to another example embodiment.

(40) FIGS. 36A and 36B are front (FIG. 36A) and rear (FIG. 36B) perspective views of a bracket, according to still another example embodiment.

(41) FIGS. 37A and 37B are front (FIG. 37A) and rear (FIG. 37B) perspective views of a bracket, according to yet another example embodiment.

(42) FIG. 38 is a front perspective view of a bracket, according to another example embodiment.

(43) FIGS. 39A and 39B are front (FIG. 39A) and rear (FIG. 39B) perspective views of a bracket, according to still another example embodiment.

(44) FIG. 40 is a front perspective view of a bracket, according to yet another example

embodiment.

(45) FIG. **41** is a front perspective view of a bracket, according to still yet another example embodiment.

(46) FIGS. **42A** and **42B** are front (FIG. **42A**) and rear (FIG. **42B**) elevation views of a bracket, according to yet another example embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(47) A portion of the disclosure of this patent document contains material which is subject to copyright protection. The copyright owner has no objection to the facsimile reproduction by anyone of the patent document or the patent disclosure, as it appears in the Patent and Trademark Office patent file or records, but otherwise reserves all copyright rights whatsoever.

(48) In the following description, references are made to various embodiments in accordance with which the disclosed subject matter can be practiced. Some embodiments may be described using the expressions one/an/another embodiment or the like, multiple instances of which do not necessarily refer to the same embodiment. Particular features, structures or characteristics associated with such instances can be combined in any suitable manner in various embodiments unless otherwise noted. By way of example, this disclosure may set out a set or list of a number of options or possibilities for an embodiment, and in such case, this disclosure specifically contemplates all clearly feasible combinations and/or permutations of items in the set or list.

(49) FIG. **1** illustrates a view of the external surfaces and working components and important features of a disinfection cabinet. The cabinet contains all electronics and drive and pump and actuating components in the area **101**, which can be separate from the interior of the cabinet to protect possible sensitive components from the harshness of disinfection methods, whereby access to area **101** can be via a separate access door from above. For the same purposes, area **101** could be located on any other side of the cabinet. A right side access door **107** the cabinet can include a see-through safety window **102** and operator control panel/screen **103**. Alternatively, a see-through window **102** could be located on any surface of the cabinet and operator control panel/screen **103** could be located on any surface of the cabinet. Security latch **104**, **112** that applies locked and sealed pressure to the door enclosure can be centrally located along the vertical dimension. One or more security latches can be used for the same purposes. Each access door offers a pull-handle **106**, located centrally on the vertical dimension. One or more door handles can be used for door opening. Door hinge **108** allows the door to swing open and contains the wiring necessary for door components whereby the threaded wiring between cabinet and door is not visible to the operator when door is open or closed. One or more door hinges could be utilized in other locations for one or more access doors. For portability ease, the cabinet can incorporate a push/pull handlebar **105**, **113** and swivel wheels **109** and fixed wheels **110** to allow a single person to easily maneuver the cabinet and steer from the handle side **111** of the cabinet. Alternatively, one or more handles can be used to grip and maneuver the cabinet and can be located elsewhere on the cabinet exterior. A left side access door **115** can feature components common to the right side access door. The wall-side of the cabinet **116** can be designed to be placed against a wall to allow for a natural separation between operating sides and openings. The cabinet can be configured to have no protruding cords or parts that can catch during transport or operation and power inlet **114** is ready to accept a common **120v** power connection and is located where any connected power cord will not interfere with operator movement or create a tripping hazard.

(50) FIG. **2** illustrates a view of the interior surfaces, working components and important features of the cabinet. Disinfection Method 1 (light) can be positioned in a manner that provides multi-bulb and multi-angle access **201**. Disinfection Method 2 (heat) can be delivered from heating element **203** and transported by air duct **202**. Disinfection Method 3 (air) can be propelled by a fan or blower **204** providing a means for moving air, pushing or pulling air within the enclosure. The fan or blower **204** can move air through a HEPA filter **205** located either interior or exterior of the cabinet. The fan or blower can be located either interior or exterior of the cabinet. Disinfection

Method 4 (vapor) can be delivered from a fogging release unit **208** and dispersed throughout the interior via circulating air propelled by fan or blower **204**. The delivered vapor can include, for example, hydrogen peroxide, water, solvent, drying agent, fragrance, or a combination thereof. The fogging release unit **208**, accordingly can be used to increase the humidity within the cabinet to a desired or target level for disinfection purposes.

(51) The above multiple disinfection methods are part of the simultaneous and serial multi-disinfection method embodiment. The application of the above disinfection methods upon items contained in the cabinet during a treatment cycle has those items transported on or within a framework **206**, the item movement multi-exposure embodiment, as one or more frames move on their center points in the complete 360° carousel movement area **207**, driven by power movement **209**, providing uniform treatment application. Alternatively, the item could be stationary and the disinfection method can be moved around the item to accomplish the above embodiment. Alternatively, the item can be moved upon a conveyor or carriage for presentation to various disinfection methods. Alternatively, the movement of items can achieve a partial or full exposure of the item as the direction and total movement of the item can be different than above. In the item movement multi-exposure embodiment, due to increased exposure of all facets of an item to various treatments the efficacy of all disinfection methods is enhanced and the time required to achieve a disinfected state is lowered respectively. One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides maximum possible item exposure to all disinfection methods and treatments by changing the position between item and disinfection method whereby simultaneous exposure is possible to each item, on all facets/sides of the item (see FIGS. **10A-D**).

(52) FIG. **3** illustrates the simultaneous and serial multi-disinfection method embodiment whereby internal space and the air, heat and vapor circulation throughout the cabinet as air enters the duct **301** at location **303**, travels through the air filter **306**, through the fan or blower assembly **305**, through heating element **304**, and exits duct **301** at location **302**, and is exposed to one or more light sources **311**. Disinfection Method 1 (light **311**), Disinfection Method 2 (heat **304**), Disinfection Method 3 (air **305**) and Disinfection Method 4 (vapor **307**, **308**) are effective due to enveloping all interior cabinet air and exposed surfaces and materials of items contained in the cabinet during a treatment cycle as the air flow is circulated and tumbled **309** from top to bottom of cabinet as item presentation framework in the form of a carousel **310** moves the items within the treatment area. Air flow can be guided for balance and best distribution of vapor and air using the air flow guide **312** to selectively deflect portions of the air flow in different directions within the enclosure. The simultaneous and serial multi-disinfection method embodiment can offer two or more disinfection methods that can include ultra-violet light, heating, cooling, air pressure, air movement, and vaporized liquids with or without chemical components, laser light, and more-all of which can be customized as part of any treatment plan based upon the items and materials to be disinfected. The amount, level, intensity, saturation, duration of any disinfection method is adjustable as needed for maximum efficacy of any treatment of any item. The above embodiments can achieve a closed system of air and item movement whereby no air is added or subtracted from the enclosure and requiring no external vents outside the enclosure. Alternatively, the above embodiments can be operated similarly if the fan or blower **204** is moving air sourced from outside the enclosure into the enclosure and moving the air in the enclosure outside the enclosure.

(53) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which can combine two or more disinfection methods in a manner that customizes a disinfection treatment plan (based upon items to be treated or contaminants targeted) and executes that plan via controls of the hardware. The objective involves a multi-method attack upon contaminants within the same treatment cycle whereby thoroughness is enhanced by employing multiple disinfection methods simultaneously or in a series within the same cycle. For example, sensitive electronic devices may be treated with UV-C and Heat but no Vapor. In another example, sensitive plastic materials may be

treated with UV-C and Vapor but no Heat. Additionally, the duration of any disinfection method is part of customized disinfection treatment plan. For example, some materials cannot tolerate long UV-C exposure and so the duration of UV-C can be shortened and other disinfection methods extended.

(54) FIG. 4 illustrates the cabinet's internal space using item physical guides to save interior space in accordance with one embodiment. As the framework carrousel **405** move at their center point 360° within carrousel movement area **406**, items contained within the carrousel could potentially shift whereby all or a portion of any item could extend beyond the carrousel movement area **406** and if so, item physical guide point **407**, **408** is positioned to nudge the item toward carrousel movement area **406** and preventing the item from leaving the carrousel movement area **406** where the item would be prevented from receiving or would prevent other items from receiving full treatment by chosen disinfection methods. The triangular form **409**, **410** on the interior of the cabinet provides the physical guide points **407**, **408** and the triangular form **409**, **410** occupies significant interior area that would otherwise be open and require more disinfection efforts if triangular forms **409**, **410** did not exist. Physical guide points could protrude from another interior surface of the cabinet to correct the position of any item as a means to the item physical guide embodiment. Interior panels could protrude from one or more surfaces to occupy space as a means to the interior space saving embodiment. The item physical guides provide a new and improved item disinfection system and method which has built-in physical guide material on the interior of the enclosure or door assembly whereby any item that becomes misaligned with its intended position as it rotates is nudged toward its original intended position so that it remains in place for exposure as well as it does not affect any other item or the cabinet's mechanisms. Alternatively, the item can be moved upon a conveyor or carriage and a similar physical guide can be positioned to assure the item remains in its intended position throughout the treatment cycle.

(55) FIG. 5 illustrates a multi-layered frame whereby any or all facets of the cabinet can have at least two layers, inner layer **501**, outer layer **502**, and a space between those layers **503**, allowing for all wiring and connectivity to be embedded between those layers and also providing insulation and heat dissipation between the interior and exterior of the cabinet. In one embodiment, all sides of the cabinet have inner layer **504** and outer layer **505** and the top and bottom sides of the cabinet have inner layer **507** and outer layer **506**.

(56) FIG. 6 illustrates the cabinet positioned as part of a room partition where a side of the cabinet **602** is placed against a wall **601** with operator loading side **606** opposite non-operator unloading side **603**, separated by a temporary or fixed partition or wall **608**, allowing for separated work areas, “dirty” loading area **607**, “clean” unloading area **605**, separated loading doorway from unloading doorway **609** from unloading entrance **610**. An operator can organize the inbound and outbound items for treatment based upon the ability for the cabinet and its design elements to be part of the room partition embodiment. Alternatively, the “dirty” loading vs. “clean” unloading access doors and their associated loading/unloading areas could be located differently than illustrated. Alternatively, the cabinet can be positioned to be part of a room partition in the middle, left or right location, as part of the room partition embodiment. This embodiment essentially includes a new and improved physical discipline in the disinfection process whereby the cabinet can have more than one access door, one or more doors for “dirty” items and one or more doors for “clean” items, allowing the operator to partition their cycle schedule and loading/unloading discipline with re-contamination risk lowered extensively. The embodiment allows for a 1st operator and 2nd operator, each operator working on separate side of the cabinet so a physical barrier can be erected around the cabinet (e.g. drape) so that the room is separated in half, dirty vs. clean (see FIG. 6).

(57) FIG. 7 illustrates the item presentation framework and attachment embodiment of the cabinet whereby item mounting attachment points **705** are located on the framework **704** in accordance with one embodiment. Item mounting attachment points refer to members, connectors, couplers,

attachment points, connection points, protruding members, apertures, and so on that may be used to support one or more objects/items within the cabinet. Item mounting attachment points can be constructed of an edge **703** adjacent to the framework **704**, an extension **702** from the framework that attaches to an anchoring point **701** whereby the anchoring point **701** has a physical attribute that provides anchoring leverage for any object with a reciprocating receiving attribute. Item mounting attachment points **705** can be spaced **706**, **707**, **708** along the framework or surface plane of the item presentation framework in an arrangement that provides flexible placement of item mounting attachments or the items themselves. Alternatively, the item presentation framework could be a different shape or dimensions while accomplishing the same mounting result for item mounting attachments, as an example, the item presentation framework could be a cylinder and item mounting attachment points can be holes and/or pegs positioned on and/or throughout the surface of the cylinder and selective physical guides can maintain the item's intended position. Alternatively, item mounting attachment points can be achieved for attachment using different attachment methods, including clips, magnets, brackets, notches, and any other means of attaching an item or item mounting bracket to the item presentation framework. For example, the item mounting attachment points **705** can be a protruding member that is detachably coupled with the framework **704**, such as shank-style fasteners (i.e., bolts, screws, pins, etc.). The protruding member can be received by an opening or aperture of a bracket, as is shown in detail below with reference to FIGS. **21** and **22**. Put another way, the aforementioned mounting attachment points **705** can be a male member, while the bracket can be a female member (i.e., an opening or aperture configured to receive the male mounting attachment point **705**). In another example, the mounting attachment points **705** can define apertures or openings that are configured to receive a protrusion, protruding member, shaft, shank, projection, etc. of a bracket, as is discussed below with reference to FIG. **23**. In such examples, the mounting attachment point **705** can be a female member that is configured to receive a male protrusion, protruding member, shaft, shank, projection, etc. of bracket. In some examples, the mounting attachment point **705** can comprise an aperture that is configured to receive a fastener (e.g., screw, rivet, pin, etc.), where the fastener is configured to be received by an opening or aperture defined by a bracket. In another embodiment, the mounting attachment point **705** can include an adhesive (e.g., sticky, adherent, epoxy, glue, etc.) element that can be configured to adhere to a bracket. In yet another example, the bracket can include an adhesive (e.g., glue, resin, epoxy, bonding agent, etc.) element that is configured to adhere to a mounting attachment point **705** or to the framework **704** generally.

(58) The item presentation framework and attachment embodiment enables rapid loading and unloading of items within the enclosure via quick-connect item mounting adapters attached to the framework. Unique mounting adapters are provided as part of one embodiment to easily fit specific categories of items without any adaptation or tie-downs or added fixtures, saving the operator loading and unloading time and allowing for a custom mix of items per the needs of the operator. Improved treatment efficacy can be achieved via the item mounting adapters as they are customized to serve each category of item and achieve maximum surface area presentation from all sides of the item which therefore achieves maximum treatment exposure on all sides of the item, thereby lowering cycle times and increasing treatment effectiveness. The movement method and the power applied to the carousel host framework can allow for 100% slippage if movement is blocked or if manual movement is desired by the operator when loading the enclosure and the carousel assembly may be rotated to face the operator for loading and unloading purposes.

(59) FIG. **8** illustrates possible item mounting brackets **805** that can be used with an item presentation framework, variably arranged and attached to the item presentation framework **801** with the item mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** as located variably throughout the framework **801**. Item mounting brackets **805** can be specifically designed for specific items found in the institution work or user environment. For example, a bracket **805** can be configured to support face shields, such as bracket **812** or the bracket assembly shown in FIGS. **30A** and **30B** and

discussed below. In another example, a bracket **805** can be configured to support eyeglasses or goggles, such as bracket **811** or the bracket assembly shown in FIGS. **36A** and **36B**. In another embodiment, a bracket **805** can be configured to support paper or cloth facemasks or gloves, such as bracket **809** or the bracket assembly shown in FIGS. **35A** and **35B** and discussed below. Furthermore, a bracket **805** can be configured to support shoes, such as bracket **808** or the bracket assembly shown in FIGS. **28A** and **28B**. In yet another embodiment, a bracket **805** can be configured to support a phone, a wallet, keys, rings, and/or various other objects, such as the bracket assembly shown in FIGS. **29A** and **29B**. For any item mounting bracket **805**, the item mounting bracket **805** can include a coupling member **806**, such as an aperture or opening as shown in FIG. **8**, that may be located within a mounting base **807**. Via the coupling member **806**, the item mounting bracket slides, snaps, affixes, attaches, couples, etc. to the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** of the item presentation framework **801**.

(60) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which employs an item hosting framework with convenient “quick change” item adapter system via universal coupling members **806** and item mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** so that various brackets **805** can be employed for the desired disinfection cycle. The operator of the cabinet may wish to employ a mix of brackets **805** for a variety of items or a concentration of a specific brackets **805** can be coupled to the item presentation framework **801** (e.g. a batch of masks and face shields). One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which employs the “quick change” item adapter system via universal attachment points whereby the item adapters quickly snap into place and have a small protruding locking pin mechanism to prevent unintentional detachment.

(61) The aforementioned mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** may correspond to a variety of brackets **805**. More specifically, one or more brackets **805** can be configured to couple with one or more of the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804**. In some embodiments, the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** are male members that correspond with female coupling members of the brackets **805** (e.g., the female members may be or include apertures **806**). In other embodiments not shown in FIG. **8**, the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** are female members that correspond with male coupling members of the brackets **805** (i.e., protrusions, protruding members, pins, shafts, projections, etc.). Each of the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** may be spaced a distance apart from an adjacent mounting attachment point **802**, **803**, **804**. In order to correspond with the mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804**, each of the male or female coupling members (e.g., aperture **806**) of the brackets **805** can also be spaced apart from an adjacent coupling member **806** at the same distance. In some embodiments, the brackets **805** may include a single coupling member **806** configured to couple with one mounting attachment point **802**, **803**, **804**. In other embodiments, the brackets **805** may include two coupling members **806** configured to couple with two mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804**. In yet other embodiments, the brackets **805** may include three coupling members configured to couple with three mounting attachment points. In various embodiments including brackets **805** having multiple coupling members **806**, the coupling members **806** may correspond to adjacent mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804**. In other embodiments including brackets **805** having multiple coupling members **806**, the coupling members **806** may correspond to mounting attachment points **802**, **803**, **804** that are not adjacent.

(62) As noted above, the brackets **805** can be specifically configured for use with certain items. For example, the brackets **805** may be designed to support a particular object in a particular manner to ensure or attempt to ensure that the object is adequately exposed to UV light, a vaporized chemical solution, circulating air, etc. within the cabinet during a disinfection or sterilization operation. In some embodiments, a particular object may be supported by a plurality of brackets **805** rather than a single bracket **805**, which may be necessary for large, heavy, or bulky objects. The variety of objects that can be supported by brackets **805** is highly configurable and related to various

industries. For example, the brackets **805** can be configured to support medical devices, personal protective equipment, physical therapy or chiropractic equipment, electronics, sporting equipment, clothing garments and accessories, eye protection equipment, and equipment regarding various other miscellaneous categories. Even more specifically, brackets **805** can be configured to support a mobile device (e.g., cell phone, tablet computer, walkie-talkie, etc.), a length of wire (for medical equipment or otherwise), a lead vest used for x-ray examinations, shoes, a facemask, a computer keyboard, laboratory or sporting goggles, gloves, eyeglasses or sunglasses, a sports ball (e.g., basketball, medicine ball, volleyball, etc.), a foam ball, a dumbbell, a foam roller, a massage device (e.g., massage gun), and so on. Furthermore, brackets **805** may be configured for general use, such as a basket for miscellaneous items, a hook for hanging items, or otherwise. Various bracket configurations are shown in FIGS. **25A-43B**, which may in some embodiments, be used in place of or in addition to brackets **805**.

(63) Thus, as alluded to above, the brackets **805** can be specifically designed for a particular object or object category. As such, the brackets **805** can be configured to support an object in a manner that maximizes the surface area of the object that is exposed to an atomized liquid disinfectant, heat treatment, circulating air, UV light photodynamic therapy, mechanical wiping or brushing, a combination thereof, etc. within the cabinet during a disinfection and/or sterilization operation. More specifically, the bracket **805** can be configured in a manner that minimizes or substantially minimizes the number of touchpoints required to support the object. The bracket **805** can be configured in a manner that prevents or substantially prevents the bracket itself from reducing disinfectant and/or sterilization exposure on the object. For example, the bracket **805** can include a plurality of small, slender support members (as opposed to thick, bulky, large, etc. support members) configured to support and/or hold the object within the cabinet, where the slender members have a narrow acute edge adjacent to the object supported and thus do not substantially obstruct one or modes of disinfectant delivery to the supported object. In another embodiment, the brackets **805** can be configured to support the object in a manner that maximizes disinfectant and/or sterilization exposure on a portion of the object on which disinfection or sterilization is particularly important or necessary based on how the object is ordinarily used or what portions of the object are most likely to be exposed to bacteria, microbes, pathogens, etc. (e.g., the screen of a phone, the handle of a dumbbell, etc.).

(64) In certain examples, a bracket **805** may be configured to support a heavy object, such as a medicine ball, portable massage device, dumbbell, kettlebell, or otherwise. Accordingly, a bracket configured to support heavy objects can include a plurality of coupling members (e.g., apertures **806**) in order to increase the structural integrity of the bracket **805** when supporting a heavy object. Moreover, such brackets can be configured to provide structural integrity by, for example, having a larger cross-sectional shape than other brackets.

(65) Brackets **805** may include visual indicators to describe their intended function (e.g., signage that indicates an intended object to support). In one embodiment, the brackets **805** are color-coded. For example, brackets **805** associated with physical therapy can be one color (e.g., green), while brackets associated with eye protection can be another color (e.g., red). Brackets **805** associated with electronics can be a third color (e.g., blue), while brackets **805** associated with personal protective equipment can be a fourth color (e.g., yellow). Brackets **805** associated with garments (e.g., shoes) can be a fifth color (e.g., white), while brackets **805** associated with miscellaneous items can be a sixth color (e.g., black). When the brackets **805** are color-coded, an operator is less likely to use an incorrect bracket in the cabinet as well as the operator is more likely to recognize their item at the end of the treatment cycle. Accordingly, it is more likely that the correct bracket **805** will be used so that disinfection and/or sterilization efficacy is maintained at a desirable level.

(66) FIG. **9** illustrates the internal cabinet space and item presentation to all disinfection methods using an offset mounting bracket whereby the item presentation framework **901** moves within the carousel movement area **904** and one or more item mounting attachments (i.e., brackets) **905**, **906**,

907, 908 are attached to the item presentation framework **901**. The attachment can be mounted with its centerline at an interior “offset angle” between 0° and 90° from parallel or substantially parallel to the item presentation framework **901**. The attachment can alternatively be mounted at an angle between 0° and 90° from a perpendicular line **903** whereby the item mounting attachments **905, 906, 907, 908** remain inside the carousel movement area **904** yet are faced openly at an offset angle. When offset, items opposite each other on the item presentation framework **901** are presented in opposing offset angles so that they do not obscure any disinfection method presentation and do not physically collide when mounted and dismounted. This can make mounting and dismounting items easier in and around the item presentation framework **901** such that mounting or dismounting an item doesn't disturb another adjacent item. To further illustrate, within any framework or base of attachment, items mounted directly adjacent or directly opposed will force contact with one another during the mounting or dismounting effort, causing items to unintentionally touch or dismount or displace. One embodiment minimizes the opportunity for items to occlude, touch or displace each other at any time.

(67) While FIG. **9** shows brackets mounted to two carousels, other embodiments of the cabinet can include one carousel or more than two carousels. For example, the cabinet shown and described with reference to FIGS. **11-17** can include a single carousel having a plurality of vertical columns, shafts, or posts coupled to a plurality of wings extending radially outward from a center point. In these embodiments, brackets can be mounted to the carousel at an offset at a predefined angle (e.g., approximately 20° , approximately 30° , etc.) relative to the vertical columns, shafts, posts, etc. of the carousel. For example, the brackets may be offset from parallel or substantially parallel to the item presentation framework **901** described above. According to an exemplary embodiment, the brackets may be offset a predefined amount (e.g., 20° plus-or-minus 5°) in a particular direction relative to the a wing of the carousel of FIG. **11** or relative to the item presentation framework **901**, as described above. The brackets may be each be offset in the same direction relative to the item presentation framework **901** (or the wing of the carousel), such as in a clockwise direction or a counterclockwise direction, in order to further prevent any obstruction or obfuscation of one object by an object on an opposing side of the item presentation framework **901**. Preventing obstruction or obfuscation further serves to bolster sterilization and/or disinfection efficacy. In other embodiments having a single carousel, the brackets can be offset at an angle of more or less than the predefined amount (e.g., approximately 20°).

(68) In various embodiments, a plurality of different brackets can couple with mounting attachment points of the item presentation framework **901**. In some embodiments, the mounting attachment points can comprise apertures configured to receive a male end of a bracket, as is shown and described below with reference to FIG. **23**. In other embodiments, the mounting attachment points can comprise protrusions, such as fasteners (e.g., screws, bolts, hooks that are coupled with the item presentation framework **901**, as is described below with reference to FIGS. **20-22**. In some embodiments, each bracket may comprise a universal bracket base that can be coupled with the item presentation framework **901**, while various bracket attachments configured to support a particular object are coupled with the universal bracket base (and therefore coupled with the item presentation framework **901**).

(69) Further disclosed herein is an item disinfection system and methods for making, distributing, and using the system with further embodiments.

(70) In accordance with one embodiment, a cabinet can include a new and improved physical enclosure which is portable by one person, can be powered by a single conventional wall outlet or equivalent, self-contained as a closed system, can be operated indoors, can be operated with average personnel with little training, is quiet in operation, and has easy operator access to the enclosure interior.

(71) In one embodiment, sensors, software and lights and screen displays serve as the control mechanisms of one embodiment to allow the operator to use, monitor, and troubleshoot the cabinet

thereby assuring a safe and effective execution of the selected disinfection treatment plan.

(72) In one embodiment, the system can be of a durable and reliable construction and may be easily and efficiently manufactured and marketed.

(73) In one embodiment, the system can be made portable so that it can be located nearest the source of contaminants, can be optionally movable by only one person, can be configured to fit through any standard doorway, can be configured to be rolled upon wheels for easier transport, and can be configured to weigh less than 250 pounds.

(74) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which is constructed of high-grade institution-grade materials such as stainless steel, has no exposed wires, with all drive and control components located outside the disinfection area but located within the cabinet container.

(75) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which is efficient in the labor required to transport, load, and unload items for treatment as well as efficient in the time required to complete a treatment plan/cycle (generally in 15 minutes or less).

(76) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method whereby the cabinet's software controls indicate the system's status whereby the operator can easily understand the status as "dirty/ready for cycle", "clean/ready to unload" with safety monitoring and messaging if a door is opened prematurely, the "dirty" door is opened before the "clean" door post-cycle, or if both "dirty" and "clean" doors are opened at the same time (these are contaminating events).

(77) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides 100% light-of-sight UV-C exposure by utilizing one or more UV-C sources whereby we position the item and light exposure to achieve via the item or treatment movement embodiment a 360 degree exposure on the horizontal plane that accomplishes a full exposure to all sides and surfaces of the item within a full range of movement (see FIGS. **10b**, **10c**).

(78) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides UV-C disinfection method from broad angles with a light-of-sight angle not less than 90 degrees up to 180 degrees in the vertical plane for any point of exposure facing the UV-C source, irrespective of item position within the enclosure. Further, this item presentation to the light achieves UV-C exposure to not less than 3 sides/surfaces of the item in the same instance (see FIG. **10D**).

(79) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides a heat disinfection method whereby varying temperatures are achieved inside the enclosure for various durations to render various living contaminants inert or dead. The cabinet monitors interior temperatures to achieve a known surface temperature of the exposed items. Based upon item material sensitivities, the temperature may be increased and time decreased or temperature may be decreased and duration increased. The cabinet can reach temperatures up to 160° F. within 40 minutes or less. The addition of the rotating carousel embodiment makes distribution of heat treatments among all items very uniform.

(80) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides air pressure and air flow disinfection enhancement method whereby the cabinet will maximize air pressure within the enclosure in order to increase the harshness of the environment upon living contaminants. The addition of the heat embodiment makes internal air especially effective in disinfection. The addition of the rotating carousel embodiment makes distribution of air among all items very uniform.

(81) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which introduces and circulates a vaporized fog throughout the interior enclosure, coating all surfaces of contained items for the purpose of disinfection or freshening of appearance or smell. The amount of vaporized liquid and duration of application is controlled per the treatment plan. The liquid is a water-based chemical solution. The addition of the rotating carousel embodiment makes

distribution of vapor treatments among all items very uniform.

(82) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides humidity disinfection enhancement method whereby the cabinet's liquid vaporization capability will increase humidity within the enclosure in order increase the harshness of the environment upon living contaminants more sensitive to heat+humidity combination. The cabinet can have the ability to apply heat+air flow+low humidity combination for maximum disinfection of one category of contaminants while separately applying heat+air flow+high humidity combination for maximum disinfection of another category of contaminants. The addition of the rotating carrousel embodiment makes distribution of heat and air and humidity treatments among all items very uniform.

(83) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides air flow drying enhancement method whereby the cabinet will move high volume of air across the surface of all contained items to facilitate drying of moist items and surfaces. The addition of the heat embodiment makes air more effective in moisture evaporation from item surfaces. The addition of the rotating carrousel embodiment makes distribution of air among all items very uniform.

(84) One embodiment provides a new and improved disinfection system and method which allows pre-set or variable treatment plans that are a combination of disinfection methods, either in serial or overlapping order, with adjusted thresholds and duration (see FIG. 10E).

(85) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which has multiple sensors that serve to control the operating environment before, during, and following a treatment cycle. Use of these sensors assures the needed environmental factors are reached and maintained to assure treatment efficacy and operator safety. If any sensor indicates an incorrect status or no status, the system will not operate (see FIG. 10F).

(86) FIG. 11 illustrates a multi-wing carrousel embodiment whereby the carrousel is driven from the drive clutch 102 that rotates the carrousel and allows for adjustable safety slippage, multiple wings 1101 connect to wing frames 1105 that provide maximum use of interior cabinet space around the center shaft 1103 which is removable to create a large interior carrousel space by removing the latch rings 1104. The multi-wing carrousel may be of unitary construction or an assembly of components coupled together. The components may include rod or beam members coupled together via one or more fasteners (e.g., screws, rivets, etc.) with or without adhesive, for example. According to an exemplary embodiment, the multi-wing carrousel can have three wings 1101. In other embodiments, the multi-wing carrousel can have fewer or more than three wings 1101. Each of the wings 1101 can be coupled to a wing frame 1105, which can be formed as a shaft, beam, post, etc. More specifically, each of the wing frames 1105 can be members that extend vertically or substantially vertical (perpendicular or substantially perpendicular relative a horizontal plane) when installed within the cabinet and connect a top member of each wing 1101 to a bottom member of the same wing 1101. Furthermore, each of the wing frames 1105 can include a plurality of bracket mounting means (e.g., item mounting attachment points 802, 803, 804) configured to couple with a bracket for supporting an item within the cabinet, particularly during a sterilization and/or disinfection cycle. In some embodiments, one or more of the wing frames 1105 can include a plurality of apertures configured to receive a male end of a bracket, as is described below in detail with reference to FIG. 23. In another embodiment, one or more of the wing frames 1105 can include a plurality of protrusions configured to be received by an aperture of a bracket, as is described in detail below with reference to FIGS. 20-22. In such embodiments, the protrusion can be a fastener (e.g., screw, bolt, etc.) that is fastened to the wing frame 1105.

(87) As noted above, a center post 1103 of the multi-wing carrousel assembly can be removable to allow for larger objects to be disinfected or to fit the operational needs of the user and bracket positioning. More specifically, the center post 1103 can be configured to detachably couple with the multi-wing carrousel assembly at a top end and a bottom end, where each of the top end and the

bottom end are coupled to the multi-wing carrousel assembly via some coupling means, shown as a latch ring **1104**. In the example shown, the latch rings **1104** can be removed from the top end and the bottom end of the center post **1103**, thereby decoupling the center post **1103** from the multi-wing carrousel assembly. In operation, apertures at the top and bottom of the center post **1103** may align with apertures at the top and bottom of the carrousel. When aligned, latch rings (e.g., pins, rods, etc.) may be inserted through the apertures to couple the center post **1103** to the assembly. In other embodiments, the center post **1103** can be coupled with the multi-wing carrousel assembly via some other means (e.g., spring-loaded pins, threading the center post **1103** into a nut coupled with the multi-wing carrousel assembly, etc.). In an exemplary embodiment, when the center post **1103** is removed, the multi-wing carrousel assembly can be configured to support one or more large, bulky, and/or heavy items via one or more of the wing frames **1105**. In some embodiments, a large, bulky, and/or heavy item can be supported by multiple brackets coupled with a wing frame **1105**. In another embodiment, a large, bulky, and/or heavy item can be supported by a plurality of brackets couple with a plurality of wing frames **1105** (e.g., a first bracket coupled with a first wing frame **1105** and a second bracket coupled with a second wing frame **1105**), as is shown and described below with reference to FIG. **24**.

(88) FIG. **12** illustrates a cross sectional elevation view of a four-corner embodiment where the rotating carrousel **1201** is surrounded by germicidal light sources **1208** as interior air is ingested **1204** into a fan **1202** outside the interior space and air is moved into the nearest corner duct **1203** moving downward to the cabinet bottom, passing by heater **1207** and re-entering the cabinet **1205** whereby the air can force interior microbes and vapor vertically while the carrousel is moving items horizontally. The resulting air flow **1205 1204** passes all along the warm surface of the germicidal light component **1208**, providing a cooling effect upon the light.

(89) FIG. **13** illustrates a cross sectional overhead view of a four-corner embodiment where the rotating carrousel **1301** is surrounded by germicidal light sources **1302** as interior air is moved into the nearest corner duct **1303** moving downward to the cabinet bottom. The corner duct **1303** can be formed in part by a front wall **1304** and/or rear wall **1305** of the cabinet, according to one embodiment. The front wall **1304** may be proximate a viewing window and handles of the cabinet, while the rear wall **1305** may be proximate a power switch and power outlet, according to one embodiment. More specifically, the front wall and the rear wall of the cabinet can comprise a C-shaped cross section whereby two ends of the front wall and rear wall curl in-wards towards an interior space or volume of the cabinet. More specifically, the front wall can include a first section **1304** and the rear wall can include a first rear section **1305**. Each of the first section **1304** and the second section **1305** can include a second section **1306** extending substantially perpendicularly to the first section **1304** or **1305** (and substantially parallel to side panels or doors), and a third section extending from the second section **1306** parallel to the first section **1304**, **1305**. A cover or panel **1308** may be coupled with an interior surface of the first section **1304**, **1305** and the third section, thereby enclosing forming the corner duct **1303** within a portion of the first section **1304**, **1305**, the second section **1306**, and the third section **1307**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the corner duct **1303** can remain enclosed (i.e., separated from the interior or exterior of the cabinet) when a side door of the cabinet is opened. The second section **1306** and the third section **1307** may also be coupled to a top and a bottom of the cabinet to provide structural support, according to one embodiment. As discussed in further detail below with reference to FIG. **16**, the corner ducts **1303** can also facilitate the circulation of air (or atomized disinfectant solution, as desired) throughout the cabinet, whether in connection with a disinfection or sterilization cycle or otherwise. For example, the corner ducts **1303** can facilitate the movement of air from a bottom of the cabinet to a top of the cabinet or vice versa.

(90) FIG. **14** illustrates a side view of a multiple access door embodiment whereby doors **1401** are located on opposite sides of the cabinet with a steering handle **1402** on each side, each door with a manual lock **1403**. A further safety door embodiment provides an automated lock **1405** on any

access door **1401**. The front-facing status embodiment allows for complete machine status to be visible from the front plane **1409** containing a computer screen HMI **1406**, status indicator lights **1407** and viewing window **1408** and manual door locks **1403**.

(91) FIG. **15** shows an embodiment including a door with pull handle **1501**, manual door lock **1504**, automated door lock **1505**, fixed wheel **1502** and steerable, lockable wheel **1503**. The automated door lock **1505** can be an electromagnetic door lock positioned between the door of the cabinet and an internal structure, such as a frame of the cabinet. The automatic lock can be configured to lock the side door in response to an indication that a disinfection and/or sterilization cycle is occurring or is scheduled to occur within a predetermined amount of time. When the door is locked, the automatic lock **1505** can substantially prevent access to an interior of the cabinet until the disinfection or sterilization cycle is complete, according to one embodiment. In another embodiment, the automatic door lock **1505** can be unlocked in response to an operator command (e.g., manual override command). The automatic locks **1505** can therefore bolster the efficacy of the device by ensuring that access to the cabinet interior is not or is substantially not allowed in certain circumstances, even if an operator forgets to lock the manual lock **1504**.

(92) FIG. **16** illustrates a perspective cut away view of a four-corner embodiment where the cabinet's structural frame is also an air duct. More specifically, structural elements (i.e., the first section **1304**, **1305**, the second section **1306**, and the third section **1307** shown in FIG. **13**) at each corner of the cabinet's interior can be a duct for moving or circulating air throughout the cabinet interior. The duct can include a top member **1601** and a bottom member **1602**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the duct extends as part of the cabinet frame the full or nearly the full length of the interior cabinet space, providing controlled air flow from top of duct **1601** to bottom of duct **1602**. In another embodiment, the duct provides controlled air flow from the bottom of the duct **1602** to the top of the duct **1601**. As carousel **1603** rotates within the cabinet interior, the air flow can be moved, directed, or otherwise guided vertically from bottom to top, from top to bottom, or otherwise. In various embodiments, the duct can circulate hot, cold, room, or another desired temperature air (for example, a heater may be used to heat the air prior to circulation, a heat exchanger may be used to cool the air prior to circulation, etc.) throughout the cabinet in connection with a disinfection or sterilization cycle. The duct can also include a plurality of perforations, apertures, vents, or openings between the top of the duct **1601** and the bottom of the duct **1602** to allow air to circulate between the top **1601** and the bottom **1602**. In some embodiments, the ducts can be fluidly coupled to one or more blower motors, fans, or other devices configured to generate air flow. Such devices can be fluidly coupled to the duct in a location proximate to the top **1601**, proximate to the bottom **1602**, or otherwise. In addition to facilitating air circulation within the cabinet, the duct as herein described can also provide structural support and rigidity for the cabinet itself. For example, the duct may be coupled to one or more adjacent walls (e.g., a front wall, back wall, bottom wall, top wall) and can act as an additional structural member within the cabinet to bolster structural rigidity thereof.

(93) FIG. **17** illustrates an embodiment of the cabinet's internal space using item physical guides. As the framework carousel moves at its center point 360° within carousel movement area **1703** items contained within the carousel could potentially shift outside of intended movement range **1702** whereby all or a portion of any item could extend beyond the carousel movement area **1703** and if so, item physical guide points **1701** are positioned to protrude and nudge the item toward carousel movement area **1703** and prevent the item from leaving the carousel movement area **1703** where the item would be prevented from receiving or would prevent other items from receiving full treatment by chosen disinfection methods. The item physical guides provide a new and improved item disinfection system and method which has built-in physical guide material on the interior of the enclosure or door assembly whereby any item that becomes misaligned with its intended position as it rotates is nudged toward its original intended position so that it remains in place for exposure as well as it does not affect any other item or the cabinet's mechanisms.

Alternatively, the item can be moved upon a conveyor or carriage and a similar physical guide can be positioned to assure the item remains in its intended position throughout the treatment cycle. (94) Referring now to FIG. 18, a disinfection cabinet **1800** is shown according to another embodiment. The disinfection cabinet **1800** can include a top portion or member **1805**, a front portion or member **1810**, a first side door **1815** coupled to a rear portion or member, a second side door **1820** coupled to the rear portion or member, and a bottom portion or member **1825**. The cabinet **1800** can include a height **1830** that spans from the top **1805** to the bottom **1825**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the height **1830** of the cabinet is less than a height of a cabinet of the embodiment shown in FIGS. 12-17. The cabinet **1800** can be configured for use on a desktop, table, countertop, or other surface that is elevated from a ground surface, for example. Because the cabinet **1800** can be used on an elevated surface, the cabinet **1800** can have a shortened height (relative to other cabinet embodiments) so that the top **1805** of the cabinet does not or likely does not interfere with a ceiling of a room or building where the cabinet **1800** is used, for example. Although the cabinet **1800** may have a shorter height **1830** than other cabinet embodiments, the interior of the cabinet can be similar to other cabinet embodiments in many respects. For example, the cabinet **1800** can include a rotating carousel structure configured to receive one or more brackets for supporting objects during a disinfection or sterilization operation.

(95) The top **1805** of the cabinet **1800** can further include a guard or shield **1835**. The guard or shield **1835** can be configured to prevent rain or other materials (e.g., debris, dust, etc.) from entering or likely entering the top **1805** of the cabinet **1800** and interfering with electronics or mechanical devices housed within the top **1805** and associated with operation of the cabinet **1800**. Beneficially, the cabinet **1800** may be disposed in outdoor environments with the electronics of the cabinet substantially shielded from various environmental conditions (e.g., rain, etc.). In some embodiments, the cabinet **1800** can be used in military environments where exposure to elements (i.e., debris, dust, vibrations, etc.) may be prevalent and the design of the cabinet **1800** includes features to assure ruggedness in the field. Accordingly the guard or shield **1835** can protect the cabinet **1800** from certain elements to ensure the cabinet **1800** operates at a desired efficacy level.

(96) The front portion or member **1810** can include a display device **1840**, one or more indicators **1845**, and can define a viewing window **1850**. In one example, the display device **1840** can include or be a touch screen device that is configured to receive an input from a user related to the operation of the cabinet **1800** and/or provide one or more graphical user interfaces. More specifically, a user may initiate a disinfection or sterilization cycle, stop the initiated cycle, monitor progress of the initiated cycle, and/or modify a disinfection or sterilization cycle of the cabinet **1800** as discussed above. The display device **1840** may also display a current status of a disinfection or sterilization cycle, such as an amount of time remaining for the cycle, a current stage of the cycle, etc. The indicators **1845** are configured to provide a visual and/or audible indication of a current status of the cabinet **1800**, the objects within the cabinet that are subject to the disinfection or sterilization cycle, and/or a combination thereof. In one example, the indicators **1845** can include three lights where each light can be configured to indicate a status of the objects within the cabinet **1800**. The lights may be LED lights or another type of light-emitting source. For example, a red light can indicate that the objects within the cabinet **1800** have not been sterilized or disinfected, a yellow light can indicate that the objects within the cabinet are currently undergoing a disinfection or sterilization, and a green light can indicate that the objects within the cabinet **1800** have been successfully disinfected or sterilized (i.e., that the cycle is complete). The indicators **1845** may thus provide a clear and substantially unambiguous visual indication to an operator or attendant of the cabinet **1800**.

(97) The viewing window **1850** can be configured to allow an operator to view an interior of the cabinet **1800**, according to an exemplary embodiment. Because UV light may be used within the cabinet to disinfect and/or sterilize, the viewing window **1850** may be coated or otherwise treated to prevent harm to the eyes of an individual viewing the interior of the cabinet during a disinfection

or sterilization cycle.

(98) The cabinet **1800** can also include two or more latches **1855** that are configured to prevent or substantially prevent an operator from accessing an interior chamber of the cabinet **1800** via doors **1815**, **1820**. In some embodiments, the latches **1855** can be manually operated latches that are actuated by an operator. In another example, the latches **1855** may be automatically locking locks. For example, the latches **1855** can be electro-magnetic or electromechanical latches that lock in response to a received electrical current, where the electrical current can be received when a disinfection and/or sterilization cycle is initiated. More specifically, an electromagnetic lock may energize mating magnetic surfaces on the side door **1820** or **1815** and the front portion member **1810**. In another embodiment, the automatic lock may be a solenoid-actuated lock that is activated to cause the movement of the latch into a latch receptacle to lock the door to the cabinet **1800**. Accordingly, the doors **1815** and **1820** may be locked when a disinfection or sterilization cycle is in process.

(99) The bottom **1825** of the cabinet **1800** may include a plurality of slots **1860**. The slots **1860** can be configured to receive tines of a hand-operated fork truck, a fork lift, a telehandler, or other equipment with fork tines, for example. In another embodiment, the slots **1860** can contain extendable carrying handles that, when extended, allow for manual movement of the cabinet by one or more operators. According to one embodiment, the bottom **1825** can include slots **1860** instead of any wheels or rollers. In another embodiment, the bottom **1825** can also include wheels, rollers, casters, etc. that allow the cabinet **1800** to be pushed or rolled along a surface. The bottom member or portion **1825** can also include friction-adding elements (e.g., rubberized feet) that are configured to prevent the cabinet **1800** from sliding or moving on a surface. In another embodiment, the bottom member or portion **1825** may further include various fixtures or brackets configured to fixedly couple the cabinet **1800** to a surface via fasteners, an adhesive, welding, etc.

(100) Referring now to FIG. **19**, a disinfection cabinet is shown, according to yet another embodiment. The cabinet **1900** is shown to include a top portion or member **1905**, a front portion or member **1910**, a first door **1915** coupled to a rear portion or member, a side panel **1920** coupled to the rear portion or member and the front portion or member **1910**, and a bottom **1925**. The top portion or member **1905** of the cabinet **1900** is also shown to include a guard or shield **1930** that may be coupled to the top portion **1905** (e.g., via one or more fasteners, such as rivets, screws, etc.) or be integral with the top portion **1905**. The guard or shield **1930** is configured to prevent rain or other materials (e.g., debris, dust, etc.) from entering the top portion or member **1905** of the cabinet **1900** and potentially interfering with any electronics or mechanical devices housed within the top portion or member **1905** and associated with the operations of the cabinet **1900**.

(101) The front portion or member **1910** is shown to include a display device **1940**, an indicator **1945**, and defining a viewing window **1950**. In some embodiments, the display device **1940** can be similar to the display device **1840** of the cabinet **1800** discussed above and shown in FIG. **18**. For example, the display device **1940** can be or include a touch screen device that is configured to receive an input from a user related to the operation of the cabinet **1900** and provide one or more graphical user interfaces. In some embodiments, the indicators **1945** can be configured to provide a visual and/or audible indication of an operational status of the cabinet **1900**, objects within the cabinet **1900** that are subject to the disinfection or sterilization cycle, and/or a combination thereof. The viewing window **1950** can be configured to allow an operator or an attendant to view an interior of the cabinet **1900**, according to an exemplary embodiment. Because UV light may be used within the cabinet to disinfect and/or sterilize, the viewing window **1950** may be coated or otherwise treated to prevent harm to the eyes of an individual viewing the interior of the cabinet during a disinfection or sterilization cycle.

(102) The first door **1915** of the cabinet **1900** is movably coupled to the cabinet **1900** (particularly, the rear portion or member) (e.g., via a hinge or other means that enables the door to move relative to the cabinet **1900**). The first door **1915** is movable, and particularly rotatable, between a first or

closed position that prevents access to an interior chamber or space of the cabinet **1900** and a second or open position where the door **1915** is spaced apart from the cabinet **1900** to provide access to an interior chamber of the cabinet **1900**. The first door **1915** can include or be coupled to a latch **1955** that, when in a latched (i.e., locked or closed) state can prevent the first door **1915** from opening (i.e., retaining the door in the first position). Rather than having a second door positioned on an opposite side from the first door **1915** (like the cabinet **1800**), the cabinet **1900** can include a side panel **1920**. The side panel **1920** may be rigidly coupled with and/or integral with the front panel or portion **1910** and a back panel or portion of the cabinet **1900**. The side panel **1920** therefore does not provide access to the interior of the cabinet **1900**. The interior space of the cabinet **1900** can therefore only be accessed via actuation of the single door **1915**, according to an exemplary embodiment. While the door **1915** is shown on a left side of the cabinet **1900** in FIG. **19**, in various examples, the first door **1915** can instead be positioned on the right side (in place of panel **1920**), on the rear portion or member (i.e., opposite side of the front portion or member **1910** shown in FIG. **19**), or on the front side. With respect to the front side configuration, the viewing window **1950**, indicator **1945**, and/or display device **1940** may be coupled to the door **1915** such that they are movable fore and aft relative to the interior space of the cabinet **1900** based on movement of the door **1915**.

(103) Referring now to FIG. **20**, a universal bracket base **2000** is shown, according to an example. As discussed above, the disinfection cabinet can be configured to couple with one or more brackets that support various objects within the cabinet. Each of the brackets can include a universal bracket base or support member **2000**, according to an exemplary embodiment. The universal bracket base **2000** can be configured to couple with an interior framework of a cabinet, such as a carrousel similar to that shown in FIGS. **8**, **9**, **11**, and **24**, for example. The universal bracket base **2000** is configured to couple to one or more brackets or bracket attachments to support one or more objects within the cabinet to undergo or experience a disinfection and/or sterilization cycle. In some embodiments, the one or more bracket attachments (or “support members”) can be detachably coupled with the universal **2000** base. Accordingly, the universal base may remain coupled to the interior framework (particularly, the carrousel) while one or more bracket attachments are coupled with or decoupled from the universal bracket base **2000**. In other embodiments, the bracket attachments can be fixedly coupled with or integrally formed with the universal bracket base **2000** such that the bracket attachment is not removable from the universal bracket base **2000**.

(104) The universal bracket base **2000** can include one or more couplers or coupling structures **2005**. The coupling structures **2005** are configured to facilitate the coupling of the universal bracket base **2000** to an interior framework or frame of a cabinet, namely a protrusion or aperture of the interior framework as described above with reference to FIGS. **7** and **8**. For example, the coupling structures may be apertures or openings that are configured to receive a protrusion, protruding member, pin, shaft, fastener, peg, etc. of a rotating carrousel of a cabinet. More specifically, the carrousel can have a plurality of wings extending radially from a center point and columns, posts, or shafts coupled to a distal end of the wings and extending vertically in a downwards direction (i.e., perpendicular or substantially perpendicular to a horizontal plane), where each of the columns, posts, or shafts can have a plurality of protrusions, protruding members, pins, shafts, fasteners, etc. that are received by the coupling structures **2005** (i.e., an aperture). In another example, the coupling structure coupled be a protrusion, protruding member, pin, shaft, fastener, etc. that is configured to be received by one or more apertures defined by the aforementioned columns, posts, or shafts of a rotating carrousel. In the example shown, the coupling structures **2005** are structured as apertures or openings **2010**. The opening **2010** is shown to include a first opening **2015** having a first diameter **2035** that flows into a second opening **2020** having a second diameter **2040**. According to one embodiment, the first diameter **2035** is greater than the second diameter **2040**. The first opening **2015** and the second opening **2020** collectively form the opening **2010**. In various embodiments, the first opening **2015** and the second opening **2020** can have the same or a similar

shape (e.g., a circular, semi-circular, or curved shape). In other embodiments, the first opening **2015** and the second opening **2020** can have a different shape (e.g., the first opening **2015** can be circular shaped while the second opening **2020** has a rectangular shape).

(105) The coupling structures **2005** of the universal bracket base **2000** are also shown to include one or more protrusions **2025** (e.g., projections, notches, etc.) extending into the opening **2010** and, in the example shown, located between the first opening **2015** and the second opening **2020**. In the example shown, the coupling structures **2005** include two protrusions **2025** positioned on opposing sides of the opening **2010** relative to each other. Ends of each of the two protrusions **2025** are separated by a protrusion distance **2045**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the protrusion distance **2045** is less than the second diameter **2040** of the second opening **2020**. As a result, the protrusions **2025** narrow the opening **2010**. More specifically, the opening **2010** can be at its narrowest between the protrusions **2025**.

(106) The universal bracket base **2000** may further include one or more bracket attachment (or support member) coupling structures, also referred to as bracket couplers **2050**. In the example shown, the bracket couplers **2050** are structured as openings or apertures **2050** defined by the base **2000**. In other embodiments, different types of bracket couplers may be employed in addition to or in place of the apertures or openings **2050** (e.g., mechanical fasteners, such as screws or bolts may be employed, the brackets may be integral with the universal base **2000**, a bonding agent may be used to couple the brackets to the base **2000**, etc.). Each aperture is structured to receive a projection of a bracket attachment to support the bracket attachment and couple the bracket attachment to the base **2000**. As noted above, the universal bracket base **2000** can be configured to couple with one or more bracket attachments. The bracket attachments can be configured to support one or more objects positioned within a disinfection and sterilization cabinet as herein described (e.g., cabinet **1800** and **1900**). Example bracket attachments (also referred to as support members), bracket bases, and bracket couplers are shown and described with respect to FIGS. **25A-42B** herein.

(107) In some embodiments, the bracket attachment or support member may be a hook configured to support a lab coat or other hanging item. In another example, the support bracket can be a small basket configured to support miscellaneous small items (e.g., medical devices, medical supplies, jewelry, fitness bands, ear buds, etc.). In yet another example, the support bracket may be a plurality of hooks configured to support a dumbbell. The support bracket may be specifically designed to support a particular object. For this reason, certain support brackets may not be compatible with certain objects. Therefore, it may be necessary for the support bracket to be changed as a certain object is placed within the cabinet. To facilitate convenient and rapid changing of bracket attachments, the universal bracket base **2000** may be configured to remain coupled with an interior framework of the cabinet (as discussed in further detail below with reference to FIGS. **21** and **22**) while the bracket attachment or support bracket is changed.

(108) In the example shown, the universal bracket base **2000** is primarily rectangular in shape, includes two coupling structures **2005** configured to enable coupling of the universal bracket base **2000** to an interior framework or frame of a cabinet, and includes four bracket couplers **2050** for coupling to one or more support brackets for supporting one or more objects within the cabinet. In one embodiment, one support bracket is coupled to one universal base **2000** (e.g., via at least one projection being received by at least one bracket coupler **2050**). In another embodiment, more than one support bracket is coupled to one universal base **2000**. For example and with reference to FIG. **20**, a first support bracket may include two projections that are received by the left most bracket couplers **2050** while a second support bracket may include two projections that are received by the right most bracket couplers **2050**. Alternatively, the two top most bracket couplers **2050** may couple to the first support bracket while the two bottom-most bracket couplers **2050** may couple to the second support bracket. Given this configurability, the bracket base **2000** may also be highly configurable: have a different shape than the depicted rectangular shape; include less than or more

than four bracket couplers **2050**; include less than or more than two coupling structures **2005**; include different shapes, sizes, and/or types of bracket couplers **2050** and/or coupling structures **2005**; and so on. Thus, the depicted configuration is exemplary only with other variations possible.

(109) Referring now briefly to FIGS. **25A-42B**, example bracket attachments or bracket assemblies are shown, are shown according to various example embodiments. In these embodiments, a bracket base is coupled to a support member to form a bracket attachment assembly. The assembly may be coupled to the frame or other internal framework of the cabinet. In other embodiments, the support member(s) and bracket base may be of integral construction (a unitary component).

(110) FIGS. **25A-25B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support a wallet, a mobile phone (or other mobile electronic or other equipment), or a tablet computer, according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **25A-25B** shows the bracket assembly including a bracket base **2501**, support members **2502** coupled to and extending outward and away from the base **2501**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **2503** of the bracket base **2501** configured to couple to the support members **2502** (e.g., apertures that receive projections of the support members **2502**). The support members **2502** are configured to support one or more objects (in this case, a mobile device but other objects are conceivable). In the example shown, the support members **2502** include a plurality of low-contact touchpoints or objects **2504**, which are shown in this example as projections with a pyramidal or conical shape.

(111) FIGS. **26A-26B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support a cord or a wire (or other type of flexible object), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **26A-26B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **2601**, support members **2602** coupled to and extending outward and away from the base **2601**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **2603** of the bracket base **2601** configured to couple to the support members **2602** (e.g., apertures that receive projections of the support members **2602**). The support members **2602** define a plurality of ridges that may support multiple objects, such as multiple wires.

(112) FIGS. **27A-27B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket support member that may be used to support a garment, such as a lead vest, according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **27A-27B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **2701**, a support member **2702** coupled to and extending outward and away from the base **2701**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **2703** that couple the support member **2702** to the base **2701** (e.g., apertures that receive projections of the support members **2702**).

(113) FIGS. **28A-28B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support a shoe, according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **28A-28B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **2801**, a support member **2802** defining a primarily S-shaped structure coupled to and extending away from the base **2801**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **2803** that are used to couple the support member **2802** to the base **2801**. In this regard, the support member **2802** can include a projection **2804** configured to be received by the bracket couplers **2803**, which are shown as apertures or openings.

(114) FIGS. **29A-29B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support rings and miscellaneous items (e.g., medical supplies, jewelry, keys, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **29A-29B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **2901**, a first support member **2902** coupled to and extending away from the base **2901**, a second support member **2903** coupled to and extending away from the base **2901** and positioned vertically beneath the first support member **2902**, a first bracket coupler **2904** of the base **2901**, and a projection **2906** of the base **2901**. The second support member **2903** may define a second bracket coupler **2905** of that is configured to receive the projection **2906** of the base **2901**. This assembly shows the usage of two different types of support members coupled to one base.

(115) FIGS. **30A-30B** show front and rear perspective views of another example bracket assembly that may be used to support a respirator, facemask, other personal protective equipment (PPE), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **30A-30B** show the bracket assembly including a

bracket base **3001**, a plurality of support members **3002**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3003**. The plurality of support members **3002** includes at least one projection **3004** that is configured to be received by the bracket couplers **3003** of the base **3001**, which are shown as apertures.

(116) FIG. **31** shows a front perspective view of another example bracket assembly that may be used to support various miscellaneous items, such as writing instruments (e.g., pens or pencils), electronic devices, bottles, etc. according to an example embodiment. FIG. **31** shows the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3101**, a first support members **3102**, a second support member **3103**, and at least one projection **3105** extending from the base **3101** in substantially a same direction as the first support member **3102** and the second support member **3103**. The first support member **3102** and the second support member **3103** can define at least one coupler **3104**, shown as an aperture. The coupler **3104** is configured to receive the projection **3105** of the base **3101**, according to one embodiment. In the example shown, the first support member **3102** includes a plurality of openings and the second support member **3103** also includes a plurality of openings that are relatively smaller in cross-sectional size than the openings of the first support member **3102**.

(117) FIGS. **32A-32B** show front and rear perspective views of another example bracket assembly member that may be used to support a computer keyboard, computer mouse, or other objects, according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **32A-32B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3201**, a first support member **3202** coupled to the base **3201**, a second support member **3203** coupled to the base **3201** and positioned vertically above the first support member **3202**, a first bracket coupler **3204**, and a second bracket coupler **3205**. The first bracket coupler **3204** is an aperture defined by the first support member **3202** and configured to receive one or more projections extending from the base **3201** to couple the first support member **3202** to the base **3201**. The second bracket coupler **3205** is an aperture defined by the base **3201** and configured to receive one or more projections extending from the second support member **3203** to couple the second support member **3203** to the base **3201**.

(118) FIGS. **33A-33B** show front and rear elevation views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support hanging items (e.g., a purse, a coat, a ID badge, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **33A-33B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3301**, a first support member **3302** coupled to the base on a left side of the base, a second support member **3303** coupled to the base **3301** on a right side of the base (opposite the first support member), a first bracket coupler **3304** of the base **3301**, and a second bracket coupler **3305** of the base **3301**. The support members **3302**, **3303** may further include projections **3306** and **3307** extending respectively from support members **3302** and **3303** that are received by the bracket couplers to couple the support members to the base **3301**. In this example, the base **3301** is structured as the universal bracket base **2000** described herein.

(119) FIGS. **34A-34B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support goggles (i.e., lab or chemistry goggles) among a variety of other objects, according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **34A-34B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3401**, a support member **3402** coupled to and extending away from the base **3401**, and a bracket coupler **3403** configured as an aperture that receives a projection from the support member **3402** to couple the support member **3402** to the base **3401**.

(120) FIGS. **35A-35B** show front and rear elevation views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support one or more items or objects (e.g., gloves, scarves, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **35A-35B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3501**, a plurality of support members **3502** coupled to and extending away from the base **3501**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3503** of the base **3501**. The support members **3502** can include one or more projections **3504** extending therefrom and configured to be received by the bracket couplers **3503** (i.e., one projection per coupler/aperture **3503**).

(121) FIGS. **36A-36B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that

may be used to support eyeglasses, sunglasses, face shields, helmets, etc., according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **36A-36B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3601**, a plurality of support members **3602** coupled to and extending away from the base **3601**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3603** of the base **3601** that are configured to receive a projection of the support member **3602** to couple the support member to the base **3601**.

(122) FIGS. **37A-37B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support sporting equipment (e.g., footballs, basketballs, volleyballs, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **37A-37B** show a bracket base **3701** (in this example, the base **3701** is structured as the universal base **2000**), a plurality of support members **3702** coupled to and extending away from the base **3701**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3703** of the base **3701** that receive projections of the support members **3702** to couple the support members **3702** to the base **3701**.

(123) FIG. **38** shows a front perspective view of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support larger objects (e.g., circular objects such as therapy ball, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIG. **38** shows the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3801**, a support member **3802** coupled to and extending away from the base **3801**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3803** (shown as apertures) that receive a projection of the support member **3802** to couple the support member **3802** to the base **3801**. The support member **3802** is shown to include a plurality of low-contact touchpoints **3804** that reduce or minimize the contact area between the object and the bracket assembly (particularly, the support member **3802**).

(124) FIGS. **39A-39B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support various objects (e.g., an umbrella, a dumbbell, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **39A-39B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **3901** (which in this example is structured as the universal base **2000** described herein), a plurality of support members **3902** coupled to the base **3901**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **3903** of the base **3901** that couple to the support members **3902** (as described herein with respect to the coupling structure of the universal base to various support members).

(125) FIG. **40** shows a front perspective view of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support a various objects/items (e.g., foam roller, a pot, a pan, etc.), according to an example embodiment. In particular, the bracket assembly of FIG. **40** may be used to support a base of a foam roller used in physical therapy and fitness settings. FIG. **40** shows the bracket assembly including a bracket base **4001**, a support member **4002** coupled to and extending away from the base **4001**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **4003** of the base **4001** that receive a projection of the support member **4002** to couple to the base **4001**.

(126) FIG. **41** shows a front perspective view of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support various objects, such as a foam roller, according to an example embodiment. In one embodiment, the bracket assembly of FIG. **41** can be used in combination with the bracket assembly of FIG. **40** to support a foam roller used in physical therapy and fitness settings. More specifically, the bracket assembly of FIG. **41** can be configured to support a cylindrical body of a foam roller. FIG. **41** shows the bracket assembly including a bracket base **4101**, a support member **4102** coupled to and extending away from the base **4101**, and a plurality of bracket couplers **4103** of the base that receive a projection of the support member **4102** to couple the support member to the base **4101**. The support member **4102** may include a plurality of low-contact features or objects **4104**, according to an exemplary embodiment. In particular, the low-contact features **4104** can contact a cylindrical body of a foam roller at two points, thereby minimizing contact between the support member **4102** and the foam roller.

(127) FIGS. **42A-42B** show front and rear perspective views of an example bracket assembly that may be used to support various objects/items (e.g., hats, massage devices, etc.), according to an example embodiment. FIGS. **42A-42B** show the bracket assembly including a bracket base **4201**, a plurality of support members **4202** coupled to and extending away from the base **4201**, and a

plurality of bracket couplers **4203** of the base that couple the support members **4202** to the base **4201**. The support members **4204** can include at least one projection **4204** extending therefrom and configured to be received by the bracket couplers **4203** in order to couple the support member to the base, as described herein.

(128) As shown in each of the bracket couplers (e.g., **2503**, **4203**), the bracket couplers may be configured to receive at least one projection (e.g., **2804**, **3306**, **3307**, **3505**, **4204**) of the support member (e.g., **2802**, **3602**, **3603**, **3502**, **4202**). The at least one projection (e.g., extension, protruding member, extending member, extension etc.) may be coupled to and extend from an end of the support member (e.g., **2802**, **3602**, **3603**, **3502**, **4202**) and/or be integral with the bracket attachment (i.e., a unitary or solitary component). The at least one projection may extend outward and away from an end of the support member. The at least one projection may include one or more raised portions that project outward and away from at least a portion of the projection. The projection is configured to couple to the bracket base **2000** (or bracket bases **2801**, **3601**, **3501**, **4201**, etc.) to couple the support member to the universal bracket base **2000**, which is described herein below.

(129) The support member (e.g., **2802**, **3602**, **3603**, **3502**, **4202**) extends into an interior of the cabinet (e.g., cabinet **1800**, **1900**). The support member (e.g., **2502**, **4202**) is configured to support, suspend, or otherwise hold one or more objects within the cabinet. As shown in FIGS. **25A-42B**, a variety of support member are depicted that have a variety of different shapes and sizes. The shapes and sizes are used to accommodate a variety of objects (e.g., dumbbells, wires, goggles/eye ware, keyboards, mobile phones, laptop computers, gloves, stethoscopes, etc.). Those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate the high configurability of the shapes and sizes that may be used to accommodate various objects, even the same type of object (i.e., multiple shapes and sizes may be used to accommodate wire objects).

(130) Many support members (e.g., **2502**, **4102**) are shown to include low-contact features (e.g., **2504**, **3804**, **4104**). For example, FIGS. **25**, **38**, and **41** show a support member **2502**, **3802**, **4102** including a plurality of points **2504**, **3804**, **4104** extending away from the support member **2502**, **3802**, **4102**. The support members can also include a plurality of ridges. The low-contact features/objects are configured to reduce a surface area contact zone for the object and the respective bracket attachment/support member (and, bracket in general). That way and beneficially, the sterilization and/or disinfection cycle is more likely to impact most of the object/item. It should be understood that a variety of low-contact features may be utilized, such that the points and ridges depicted are not meant to be limiting with other structures having other shapes and sized envisioned.

(131) In some embodiments, the support members of the various bracket assemblies shown in FIGS. **25A-42B** can include securing members configured to secure the object to the support member in order to reduce a movement of object with respect to the support member while the object is supported on the bracket assembly. For example, the securing member can include a plurality of sprung metal clips (e.g., alligator clips, electrical clips, and the like) that can clip to (i.e., apply a clamping force to) an object supported by the bracket assembly. The securing members could be directly coupled to the support members in one embodiment (e.g., rotationally coupled via rivets to the support members). In another embodiment, the securing members could be indirectly coupled with the support members. For example, the securing members could be coupled with a tether (e.g., a rope, string, etc.), where tether is coupled to the support member. In various embodiments, the securing member can be configured to substantially ensure the object does not move during a disinfection cycle, particularly when the interior framework of the cabinet is in motion (i.e., a rotating carousel is rotating) and/or when air is circulated within an interior of the cabinet.

(132) Multiple base configurations/structures are shown in FIGS. **25A-42B** with some embodiments showing the universal base **2000**. While different base shapes and sizes are shown,

the coupling mechanism of the support member to the base is substantially consistent throughout, which is described in more detail below with respect to the universal base **2000**.

(133) Based on the foregoing, coupling of the bracket/support member to the universal base **2000** may be described as follows. The apertures **2050** of the universal bracket base **2000** may be configured to receive projections (e.g., **2804**, **3306**, **3307**, **3504**, **4204**) of a support member/bracket attachment (e.g., **2802**, **3602**, **3603**, **3502**, **4202**). Each of the aforementioned projections of a bracket attachments may be inserted into a bracket coupler (e.g., **2050**, **2803**, **3604**, **3605**, **3503**, **4203** that is shown as an aperture/opening) where, in doing so, causes the projection (and any raised portions associated therewith) to flex or move because the size of the aperture **2050** or bracket coupler (cross-sectional size) may be relatively smaller than the cross-sectional size of the projection (and any raised portions associated therewith). Once a substantial portion of the projection is pushed through the aperture **2050** or bracket coupler, the projection (and any raised portions associated therewith may spring, expand, flex, or otherwise move back to a non-flexed position. This causes the raised portions associated with the projection to engage with the universal bracket **2000** (e.g., contact, etc.) in a way that prevents the projection and bracket attachment from being removed from the universal bracket **2000** (i.e., clip into place). To remove the bracket and insert a new bracket to the bracket **2000**, a user may move the projection inward to enable that portion to be slid or moved out of the apertures **2050** to disconnect the bracket from the base **2000**.

(134) Whether apertures, protrusions, or other coupling means are employed, in one embodiment, the bracket couplers of the base can be angled or offset with respect to a back surface of the universal bracket base **2000** (shown as back surface **2145** of FIG. **21**). As a result, the support member can be angled (i.e., offset) with respect to the back surface **2145** of the universal bracket base **2000**. As discussed above with reference to FIG. **9**, the support members may desirably be offset with respect to the back surface **2145** and the interior framework of the cabinet in order to optimize exposure to vaporized/atomized chemicals, UV light, heated air, etc. during a disinfection and/or sterilization cycle within the cabinet. In some embodiments, both the bracket attachment coupling means and the bracket attachment itself will be oriented such that the object supported by the bracket within the cabinet is “offset” as herein described. In another embodiment, the base **2000** may not include the offset/angle yet the support member itself includes a body portion coupled to the projection to offset the support member (put at an angle) relative to the base **2000**. The angling/offset may enable relatively more objects to be included in the cabinet.

(135) In various embodiments, the universal bracket base **2000** and/or the support member can comprise a semi-malleable or ductile material. For example, each of the universal bracket base **2000** and the bracket attachment/support member can be or comprise plastic material. In another embodiment, a portion of the universal bracket base **2000** and/or the bracket attachment/support member can comprise a plastic material, while a remainder of the universal bracket base **2000** and the bracket attachment comprise another material (e.g., a metal material). For example, the coupling structure **2005** of the universal bracket base **2000** and the protruding member of the bracket attachment can comprise a plastic material while the remainder of the universal bracket base **2000** and the bracket attachment comprise some other material.

(136) Referring now to FIG. **21**, a cross-sectional view of the base **2000** is depicted, according to an example embodiment. As shown, the base **2000** includes a fastener **2105**. The fastener **2105** (e.g., screw, bolt, etc.) can be inserted within the opening **2010** of one or more couplers **2005** of the universal bracket base **2000** described above with respect to FIG. **20**. A plurality of fasteners **2105** are coupled to the carousel structure to facilitate coupling to a plurality of bases **2000**. The fastener **2105** can have a head **2110**, a shaft **2115**, and a threaded portion **2120**. The head **2110** has a head diameter **2125**. The shaft **2115** can a shaft diameter **2130**. According to one embodiment, the head diameter **2125** is less than the first diameter **2035** of the universal bracket base **2000**, but larger than the second diameter **2040** of the universal bracket base **2000**. The shaft diameter **2130** can be less than both the first diameter **2035** and the second diameter **2040** of the universal bracket base

2000, according to various embodiments. In some embodiments, the shaft diameter **2130** can be greater than the protrusion distance **2045**. The threaded portion **2120** can be configured to thread into an aperture of the interior framework of a cabinet, according to one embodiment. In other embodiments, the fastener may be coupled to the interior framework of the cabinet by some other means (e.g., welding, press-fitting, adhesive,) or may be integrally formed with the interior framework of the cabinet.

(137) The universal bracket base **2000** can be installed to the internal cabinet framework by securing the universal bracket base **2000** over one or more fasteners **2105** (e.g., pegs, etc.). With one or more fasteners **2105** coupled with the interior framework (e.g., a rotating carousel having a plurality of wings extending radially from an axis of rotation, the wings coupled to one or more vertically-oriented shafts, columns, or posts, where the shafts, columns, or posts are configured to couple with a universal bracket base) of the cabinet, the head **2110** of each fastener **2105** may be inserted through the first opening **2015** such that the head **2110** extends beyond surface **2030**. In one embodiment, the universal bracket base **2000** can be translated in direction **2140** relative to the fasteners **2105** while the fasteners **2105** remain coupled with the interior framework of the cabinet. As the universal bracket base **2000** is translated, the shaft **2115** of each fastener **2105** passes or extends through the two protrusions **2025** of each coupler **2005**. As noted above, the protrusion distance **2045** is less than the shaft diameter **2130**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the protrusions **2025** can be configured to deform slightly in order to allow the shaft **2115** of a fastener **2105** to pass between the protrusions **2025**. As noted above, each protrusion **2025** may comprise a malleable or ductile material that can deform slightly to allow the shaft **2115** to pass between the protrusions **2025** before substantially returning to its original shape. After the shaft **2115** of each fastener **2105** passes through the protrusions **2025**, the shaft **2115** of each fastener **2105** can extend through the second opening **2020** of each respective coupling means **2005**. Furthermore, with the shaft **2115** extending through the second opening **2020**, the protrusions **2025** of the coupler **2005** are beneath the shaft **2115** and can retain the shaft **2115** within the second opening **2020**, according to an exemplary embodiment. In this way, the universal bracket base **2000** is substantially kept from moving relative to the shaft **2115** because the shaft **2115** (and the fastener **2015** more generally) are bounded by the protrusions **2025** and the second opening **2020**. When the shaft **2115** is bounded by the protrusions **2025** and the second opening **2020**, the universal bracket base **2000** is in an installed position.

(138) As indicated above, the surface **2030** can be a pitched or angled surface, as shown in detail in FIG. 22. According to an exemplary embodiment, the surface **2030** can be pitched or angled such that a wall thickness **2205** of the coupler **2005** at the first opening **2015** is smaller than a wall thickness **2210** of the coupler **2005** at the second opening **2020**. The surface **2030** can be pitched at an angle **2215** relative to a flat surface **2220**, according to an exemplary embodiment. Moreover, the wall thickness **2215** of the coupler **2005** proximate to the second opening **2020** can be substantially similar to a distance from the head **2110** of a fastener to the interior framework of the cabinet. In this way, as the universal bracket base **2000** is translated in direction **2140** relative to the fasteners **2105** towards the aforementioned installed position, the coupler **2005** tightens against the head **2110** of the fastener **2105**. Specifically, when the universal bracket base **2000** is in the installed position (i.e., when the fastener shaft **2115** is within the second opening and has passed between the protrusions **2025**), the surface **2030** contacts (e.g., engages) a back surface of the head **2110**, further securing the universal bracket base **2000** to the fastener **2105** and interior framework of the cabinet.

(139) Referring now to FIG. 23, a universal bracket base **2300** is shown, according to another example embodiment. The universal bracket base **2300** can be configured to couple with an interior framework (e.g., rotating carousel) of a disinfection and sterilization cabinet, as herein described. The universal bracket base **2300** can include one or more coupling structures, couplers, coupling elements, etc. **2305**. In contrast to the opening **2010** of the universal bracket base **2000** shown in

FIGS. 20-22 and discussed above, the coupling structures 2305 of the universal bracket base 2300 are configured as protruding members 2310. In this example, two protruding members 2310 are included with the base 2300. In other example embodiments, fewer or more than two protruding members 2310 are included with the base 2000. The protruding member 2310 can be configured to be received by one or more apertures of the interior framework of the cabinet, such as an aperture defined by a post or beam of the internal cabinet framework (e.g., the wing frame 1105 as shown in FIG. 11). Each protruding member 2310 can include a minor diameter 2315 that is smaller than a diameter of the aperture of the interior framework. Furthermore, each protruding member 2310 can include a major diameter 2320 that is greater than the diameter of the interior framework.

According to an exemplary embodiment, portions of the protruding member 2310 including the major diameter 2320 may slightly deform as the protruding member 2310 is inserted into the aperture of the interior framework. Once inserted into the aperture of the interior framework, the portion of the protruding member 2310 including the major diameter 2320 may substantially return to its original shape (i.e., expand), thereby preventing the protruding member 2310 from being removed from the aperture of the interior framework. According to an exemplary embodiment, a resistance force must be overcome before the portions of the protruding member 2310 having the major diameter 2320 can be deformed to insert the protruding member 2310 into or remove the protruding member 2310 from the aperture of the interior framework.

(140) The universal bracket base 2300 can also include bracket attachment coupling means, shown as apertures 2325. According to an exemplary embodiment the apertures 2325 can be similar to the apertures 2050 shown in FIGS. 20 and 21 and described above. In various embodiments, the protruding members 2310 can be integrally formed with the universal bracket base 2300 such that the universal bracket base 2300 and the protruding members 2310 comprise a single part, according to one embodiment. In another embodiment, the protruding members 2310 can be fastened to or coupled with the universal bracket base 2300.

(141) In another embodiment, the protruding members 2310 of the universal bracket base 2300 can be received clipping members of the interior framework of the cabinet. More specifically, the interior framework can include one or more electrical clips, alligator clips, spring-loaded metal or plastic clip with serrated jaws, or other clip device that is configured to apply a clamping force to an object placed within a pair of clip jaws. Serrated teeth of clip jaws may apply a clamping force to one or more of the protruding members 2310 of the universal bracket base 2300, according to one embodiment. In another embodiment, a universal bracket base (e.g., universal bracket base 2000) can have a clipping device (e.g., alligator clip, sprung metal clip with serrated jaws, etc.) as coupling members that are configured to clip to shafts, protrusions, protruding members, pins, etc. of the interior framework of the cabinet.

(142) Referring now to FIG. 24, an interior framework 2400 of a disinfection or sterilization cabinet is shown, according to an exemplary embodiment. The interior framework 2400 can include a carousel 2405 that can be configured to rotate about a central axis, according to an exemplary embodiment. As described above with reference to FIG. 11 and others, the carousel may be driven via a drive-clutch that allows the carousel to rotate in one direction with and allows for appropriate safety slippage in the event the carousel 2405 crashes into an object within the cabinet. The drive-clutch may be communicably coupled to the display device (e.g., display device 1840 or 1940) such that a user may control the rotation of the carousel 2405 via the display device. The rotating carousel 2405 can include a plurality of wings, such as wings 2410 and 2415. In an exemplary embodiment, the rotating carousel 2405 can include three wings. As described above, a bracket may be coupled the interior framework, namely to posts or beams positioned proximate to a distal end of each wing (e.g., to wing frames 1105 as shown in FIG. 11). More specifically, the one or more brackets may be coupled to the interior framework of the cabinet such that the bracket is “offset” from the frame, as discussed in detail above with reference to FIGS. 9 and 20. In some embodiments, the object to be disinfected or sterilized is too large, heavy, or bulky to be supported

by a single bracket or by multiple brackets coupled along a single wing of the carousel. Accordingly, circumstances may arise where it may be desirable to support an object (e.g., a lead vest) using a plurality of brackets coupled with the interior framework of the cabinet via multiple wings.

(143) More specifically, and as shown in FIG. 24, a first bracket or bracket assembly **2420** can be coupled to the first wing **2410** of the carousel **2405**, while a second bracket or bracket assembly **2425** can be coupled to the second wing **2415** of the carousel **2405**. Rather than each bracket or bracket assembly **2420**, **2425** being offset in the same direction (i.e., clockwise or counterclockwise) relative to wings **2410**, **2415**, respectively, bracket assemblies **2420** and **2425** are offset in opposite directions. In particular, the first bracket or bracket assembly **2420** is offset relative to wing **2410** in a first direction, while the second bracket or bracket assembly **2425** is offset from wing **2415** in a second direction. According to one embodiment, the two bracket assemblies **2420**, **2425** can be offset in a direction facing the other bracket assembly **2425**, **2520**. The first bracket **2420** can be offset at a first angle **2430** from a wing centerline **2445**. The second bracket **2425** can be offset from at a second angle **2440** from a second wing centerline **2445**. According to an exemplary embodiment, the first angle **2430** and the second angle **2440** may be substantially similar (albeit in different directions).

(144) Although substantially similar offset angles of multiple brackets can be used prevent one supported object from obscuring or occluding another supported object from exposure to vaporized/atomized chemicals, UV light, heated air, etc. during a sterilization or disinfection cycle as noted above with reference to FIG. 9, the example of FIG. 24 represents an instance where differing offset angles of various brackets may be necessary. When large, heavy, or bulky objects are supported within the cabinets as shown in FIG. 24, it may also be necessary to remove the center shaft (e.g., center shaft **1103** shown in FIG. 11) of the carousel **2405** to bolster exposure to vaporized/atomized chemicals, UV light, heated air, etc.

(145) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides the operator with an operator viewing window that is safety glass and UV-C resistant thereby allowing the operator to observe the interior of the cabinet at all times.

(146) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides the operator with an operator screen that allows the selection of cycle modes, settings, timings, as well as system status communication methods whereby the operator can see the current status, error messages, instructions and more.

(147) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which has lights and indicators on both operating sides of the cabinet whereby the lights and screens communicate the machine status (e.g. “Dirty/Ready for Loading”, “In-Use”, “Clean/Ready for Unloading”, etc.) using colors and words to easily convey to the operator a status.

(148) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which features a full system test cycle upon powering up the cabinet. A test cycle tests all disinfection subsystems and sensors for proper working order and asks the operator to confirm a success. This test cycle provides confidence that all subsequent activity is being performed properly.

(149) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which includes dynamic control software that contains actions and decisions using sensor inputs to perform the selected disinfection treatment cycle.

(150) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which has a smooth exterior surface on all sides with no exposed wires or cords or protruding parts that could be caught during operation or transportation of the cabinet.

(151) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which requires only a single **120v 15a** power connection to accomplish all operations and is easily powered by external power generators or a battery pack.

(152) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which

enables matching the disinfection treatment plan to the items (and their materials) requiring disinfection. A disinfection treatment plan is based upon [contaminant×materials×disinfection method×duration]. The ability to include (or exclude) a disinfection method based upon a material match (or conflict) is part of this embodiment.

(153) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides operating software controls that assure a disciplined/metered treatment efficacy for the varied items and materials and contaminants requiring disinfection, operate and communicate system and cycle status.

(154) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which can be self-operated by the institution, requiring no 3rd party expense or dependency.

(155) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which is a “closed system” whereby no air or vapor may be evacuated outside the enclosure for any purpose during or following the operation of the cabinet. The system is self-contained and inert at the end of any cycle whereby the enclosure, items, contaminants, and disinfection materials used in the treatment cycle do not affect the cabinet's operator or item's user or the cabinet's operating environment whereby additional precautions may be taken post-treatment or post-cycle.

(156) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides multiple disinfection methods and item manipulation whereby the cabinet maintains a sound level of 85 decibels or less and cannot be detected from outside a sealed operating area.

(157) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which allows the operator to place and remove items within the cabinet without having to step into the enclosure or reach or bend or stoop in a manner that causes physical strain or long-term fatigue or injury. A further object is to allow 100% access to the entire enclosure from any door whereby there are no physical panels or barriers between any portion of the interior workspace and the outside when the door is opened (this means the doors can be 100% of the side of the enclosure).

(158) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which allows an item to fall from its original mounted position inside the enclosure to the bottom of the enclosure whereby the system can continue to operate without damaging the item else the system will stop operating. A further object is to have no moving parts, technology, or any component at the bottom of the enclosure whereby items or fluids could interfere with a disinfection cycle or damage the enclosure or its components.

(159) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which is susceptible to a low cost of manufacture with regard to both materials and labor, and which accordingly is then susceptible to low prices of sale to the consuming industry, thereby making such cabinet economically available to those in the industry.

(160) One embodiment provides a new and improved item disinfection system and method which provides all of the advantages of the prior art, while simultaneously overcoming some of the disadvantages normally associated therewith.

CONCLUSION

(161) Although the subject matter has been described in terms of certain embodiments, other embodiments that may or may not provide various features and aspects set forth herein shall be understood to be contemplated by this disclosure. The specific embodiments described above are disclosed as examples only, and the scope of the patented subject matter is defined by the claims that follow. In the claims, the terms “based upon” and “based on” shall include situations in which a factor is taken into account directly and/or indirectly, and possibly in conjunction with other factors, in producing a result or effect. In the claims, a portion shall include greater than none and up to the whole of a thing.

(162) Although this description may discuss a specific order of method steps, the order of the steps may differ from what is outlined. Also two or more steps may be performed concurrently or with partial concurrence. Such variation will depend on the software and hardware systems chosen and

on designer choice. All such variations are within the scope of the disclosure. Likewise, software implementations could be accomplished with standard programming techniques with rule-based logic and other logic to accomplish the various connection steps, processing steps, comparison steps, and decision steps.

(163) As utilized herein, the terms “approximately”, “about”, “substantially”, and similar terms are intended to have a broad meaning in harmony with the common and accepted usage by those of ordinary skill in the art to which the subject matter of this disclosure pertains. It should be understood by those of skill in the art who review this disclosure that these terms are intended to allow a description of certain features described and claimed without restricting the scope of these features to the precise numerical ranges provided. Accordingly, these terms should be interpreted as indicating that insubstantial or inconsequential modifications or alterations of the subject matter described and claimed are considered to be within the scope of the invention as recited in the appended claims.

(164) It should be noted that the term “exemplary” as used herein to describe various embodiments is intended to indicate that such embodiments are possible examples, representations, and/or illustrations of possible embodiments (and such term is not intended to connote that such embodiments are necessarily extraordinary or superlative examples).

(165) The terms “coupled,” “connected,” and the like, as used herein, mean the joining of two members directly or indirectly to one another. Such joining may be stationary (e.g., permanent, etc.) or moveable (e.g., removable, releasable, etc.). Such joining may be achieved with the two members or the two members and any additional intermediate members being integrally formed as a single unitary body with one another or with the two members or the two members and any additional intermediate members being attached to one another.

(166) References herein to the positions of elements (e.g., “top,” “bottom,” “above,” “below,” “between,” etc.) are merely used to describe the orientation of various elements in the figures. It should be noted that the orientation of various elements may differ according to other exemplary embodiments, and that such variations are intended to be encompassed by the present disclosure.

(167) It is important to note that the construction and arrangement of the electromechanical variable transmission as shown in the exemplary embodiments is illustrative only. Although only a few embodiments of the present disclosure have been described in detail, those skilled in the art who review this disclosure will readily appreciate that many modifications are possible (e.g., variations in sizes, dimensions, structures, shapes and proportions of the various elements, values of parameters, mounting arrangements, use of materials, colors, orientations, etc.) without materially departing from the novel teachings and advantages of the subject matter recited. For example, elements shown as integrally formed may be constructed of multiple parts or elements. It should be noted that the elements and/or assemblies of the components described herein may be constructed from any of a wide variety of materials that provide sufficient strength or durability, in any of a wide variety of colors, textures, and combinations. Accordingly, all such modifications are intended to be included within the scope of the present inventions. Other substitutions, modifications, changes, and omissions may be made in the design, operating conditions, and arrangement of the preferred and other exemplary embodiments without departing from scope of the present disclosure or from the spirit of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A disinfection or sterilization cabinet, comprising: a cabinet frame defining an interior cabinet space; at least one door coupled to the cabinet frame, the at least one door movable between a first position that substantially prevents access to the interior cabinet space and a second position spaced apart from the cabinet frame that enables access to the interior cabinet space; an internal cabinet framework coupled to the cabinet frame and disposed within the interior cabinet space, the internal

cabinet framework comprising at least one bracket coupling structure; at least one bracket removably coupled to the internal cabinet framework via the at least one bracket coupling structure, the at least one bracket including a support member detachably coupled with a bracket base, the bracket base defining a back surface and an opening extending at least partially toward the back surface, the back surface positioned proximate the bracket coupling structure of the interior cabinet framework with the bracket coupled to the internal cabinet framework, the support member including a projection, the opening to receive the projection of the support member to position the support member at an angle relative to the back surface of the bracket base, wherein the support member includes a low contact object configured to reduce a contact area of an object supported by the at least one bracket; and at least one disinfectant or sterilization element configured to at least partially disinfect or sterilize the object supported by the at least one bracket.

2. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 1, wherein the bracket coupling structure includes a fastener coupled with and extending from the internal cabinet framework, wherein the at least one bracket defines a second opening configured to receive the fastener.

3. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 2, the at least one bracket further comprising a protrusion extending into the second opening, wherein the second opening comprises a first portion having a first diameter, a second portion having a second diameter, and a protrusion distance, wherein the protrusion is positioned between first portion and the second portion.

4. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 3, the fastener further comprising a head having a head diameter and a shank having a shank diameter, wherein the head diameter is less than the first diameter but greater than the second diameter, wherein the shank diameter is less than the second diameter but greater than the protrusion distance.

5. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 4, wherein the protrusion comprises a malleable material that is configured to deform as the fastener is received by the second opening and is moved from the first portion to the second portion past the protrusion.

6. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 1, wherein the bracket coupling structure comprises an aperture, wherein the at least one bracket comprises a protrusion configured to be received by the aperture.

7. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 6, wherein the protrusion comprises a projection extending away from the protrusion, the projection configured to move to couple the bracket to the internal cabinet framework.

8. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 1, wherein the cabinet frame includes support structures that define a duct, the duct configured to direct air towards the interior cabinet space.

9. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 1, wherein the internal cabinet framework comprises a carousel comprising a shaft, the carousel configured to rotate about an axis, the shaft spaced apart from the axis wherein the shaft comprises the bracket coupling structure.

10. The disinfection or sterilization cabinet of claim 9, wherein the opening of the bracket base is oriented at an oblique angle relative to the back surface of the bracket base such that the support member is positioned at an oblique angle relative to the back surface of the bracket base, the support member extending at least partially toward the axis when coupled with the bracket coupling structure.
